

The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called 'The Jewel Casket'

Ārya-ratnakaraṇḍa-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 117 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དཀར་མཆོག་གི་མཉམ་བུ་ཐཱ་བུ་ཐཱ་བུ་པ་ཆེ་པའི་མདོ།

Toh 117 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-ratnakaraṇḍa-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra and in Tibetan as Pakpa Könchok gi Zamatok Chéjawa Tekpa Chenpo'i Do, rendered in English as "The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called The Jewel Casket." It belongs to the sūtra section of the Kangyur and takes the form of a discourse delivered by the Buddha to a vast assembly of monks and bodhisattvas at the Jeta Grove in Śrāvastī. The text features the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī as a prominent interlocutor, arriving alongside thousands of bodhisattvas and divine beings, and unfolds as a teaching on Mahāyāna principles framed within this richly described gathering. The title's image of a jewel casket suggests a treasury of precious Dharma, pointing to the text's character as a repository of important Buddhist teachings intended for those pursuing the bodhisattva path.

In the language of India: Ārya-ratnakaraṇḍa-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called "The Jewel Casket."

First fascicle.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great Saṅgha of twelve hundred and fifty monks and ten thousand bodhisattvas.

At that time, in the surrounding courtyard of the bamboo grove, the Blessed One was teaching the Dharma, encircled by many hundreds of thousands of attendants, seated facing forward.

Then Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, accompanied by five thousand bodhisattvas, surrounded by Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, and the world-protectors, and preceded by them, went to where the surrounding courtyard of the bamboo grove was and where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, he bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and then, together with those bodhisattvas, Śakra, Brahmā, and the world-protectors, took his seat to one

side.

Having taken his seat to one side, Mañjuśrī in his youthful form addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what teaching are you giving at this moment? Blessed One, please continue that very teaching without interruption."

Then, through the power of the Buddha, the venerable Subhūti said to Mañjuśrī in his youthful form: "Mañjuśrī, the Blessed One is now giving a teaching in the presence of those who are hearers. Mañjuśrī, I urge you: take courage and begin a teaching in the presence of bodhisattvas."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Subhūti, since all hearers and pratyekabuddhas have not become vessels for discourse pertaining to bodhisattvas, what use is it, Venerable Subhūti, to give such a discourse?"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, then speak to those among the assembly here who have become vessels."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Subhūti, do you know who here are vessels and who are not vessels?"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, I merely follow the words of others — how would I know vessels from non-vessels? Nevertheless, Mañjuśrī, take courage and begin a discourse pertaining to bodhisattvas."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, all those who have entered into what is without fault are not vessels for the qualities of a buddha. Venerable Subhūti, those who reflect even on what is without fault, and who look upon sentient beings, yet do not fall into what is without fault and do not abide together with fault — these are vessels for the qualities of a buddha.

"Furthermore, Venerable Subhūti, those who are established in the middle, who have entered into the qualities of those still in training and those beyond training, who are equanimous toward all sentient beings, who regard existence as though it were a blazing fire, whose minds are utterly weary, who are terrified by all three realms, and who do not delight in bringing about existence even for a single moment — these are not vessels for the qualities of a buddha.

"Venerable Subhūti, those who have donned armor for tens of millions of kalpas unto the furthest end of the future, who are unafraid and undaunted by all of existence, whose range of activity is the three realms, who are free from the three defilements, who conceive of saṃsāra as a pleasure grove and a

celestial palace, who desire existence and yet are free from attachment to all of existence — these are vessels for the qualities of a buddha."

"Venerable Subhūti, furthermore, those who have abandoned all attachment, aversion, delusion, latent tendencies, entanglements, afflictions, and secondary afflictions — these are not vessels for the qualities of a buddha."

"Venerable Subhūti, those who are not gripped by attachment yet display the conduct of attachment; who are not overcome by aversion yet display the conduct of aversion; who are not bewildered by delusion yet display the conduct of delusion; who are free from affliction yet appear throughout the three realms; who have loving-kindness toward all sentient beings; who are not arrogant, not timid; who bear the burden of all sentient beings; who follow in accordance with suchness; who have entered upon the path in order to make the lineage of the Three Jewels unbroken; who possess the three knowledges and have made those knowledges manifest — these are vessels for the qualities of a buddha."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, if the dharmadhātu is one, suchness is one, and the perfect limit is one, then how does being a vessel or not being a vessel appear?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, consider this analogy: a potter takes a single lump of clay and fashions from it vessels of many different kinds, then fires all those vessels together. Some of them become vessels for grain oil and butter. Some become vessels for honey and molasses. Some become vessels for foul and impure things. Yet in the lump of clay from which they were made and in the firing, there is not the slightest difference."

"Venerable Subhūti, in exactly the same way: although the dharmadhātu is one, suchness is one, and the perfect limit is one, it is through the prior accumulation of karma that the distinction of vessels arises. As for the vessels for honey and molasses — regard all bodhisattvas in that light. As for the vessels for grain oil and butter — regard all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas in that light. As for the vessels for foul and impure things — regard all childish ordinary persons in that light."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, is there a category by which those who are vessels become non-vessels, and those who are non-vessels become vessels?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, yes there is."

Subhūti said: "By what category do those who are vessels become non-vessels, and those who are non-vessels become vessels?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, those who have become vessels for all afflictions and have not broken the connection of habitual tendencies — these are not vessels for the qualities of a buddha. Venerable Subhūti, those who have not become vessels for all afflictions and have broken the connection of habitual tendencies — these are vessels for the qualities of a buddha."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, what is to be placed inside a vessel?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, nothing whatsoever. Why? When a bodhisattva engages in conduct that is without putting in and without taking out, one should recognize that as the very essence of the vessel. When one engages in putting in and taking out, one should recognize the vessel as broken.

"Venerable Subhūti, consider this: space is called the vessel of all grasses, creeping plants, medicines, and forests, and yet it is not the vessel of any of them."

"Venerable Subhūti, in just the same way, a bodhisattva is also called the vessel of all the qualities of a buddha, and yet is not the vessel of any of them. Venerable Subhūti, consider this: trees that grow from the earth arise because space is their vessel. Venerable Subhūti, in just the same way, bodhisattvas who are born from superior intention also arise because the Perfection of Wisdom is their vessel."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, do bodhisattvas arise?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, if space arises, then bodhisattvas might also arise. But space neither arises nor is it ever exhausted. Venerable Subhūti, in just the same way, bodhisattvas neither arise nor are ever exhausted."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, on what basis do you say that bodhisattvas neither arise nor are ever exhausted?"

Mañjuśrī said: "The afflictions do not arise, and one does not fall away from the qualities of a buddha."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, what distinction can be drawn between the afflictions and the qualities of a buddha?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, there is not even the slightest distinction to be drawn between the afflictions and the qualities of a buddha. Venerable Subhūti, consider this: when all forms are touched by the light of Mount Meru, the king of mountains, they become one color, the color of gold. Venerable Subhūti, in just the same way, the afflictions illuminated by wisdom and gnosis also become one color, the color of the qualities of a buddha. Venerable Subhūti, therefore, between the afflictions illuminated by wisdom and gnosis and the qualities of a buddha there is not even the slightest distinction — and for that reason all phenomena are called the qualities of a buddha."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, why are all phenomena called the qualities of a buddha?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, because they are realized just as they are."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, what does 'just as they are' indicate?"

Mañjuśrī said: "What is so at the beginning is equally so at the end, without ever departing from suchness — therefore it is called 'just as it is.'"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, what do 'the beginning' and 'the end' indicate?"

Mañjuśrī said: "The beginning is emptiness; the end is solitariness. Therefore one speaks of 'beginning' and 'end.'"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, what distinction can be drawn between emptiness and solitariness?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, what do you think? Is there any distinction between gold and a hollow reed?"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, in terms of the names assigned to them there is a distinction."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, in just the same way, emptiness and solitariness are nothing more than names and conventions. The wise have no attachment to names and conventions; it is the childish who are attached to them."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the defining characteristic of the childish, and what is the defining characteristic of the wise?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, the Blessed One has said that the childish are defined by karma."

"And the wise," he said, "are defined by the Dharma."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, what is the defining characteristic of karma?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, the defining characteristic of dependent origination is karma. Among those who actively construct and accumulate, existence appears. Among those who do not actively construct and accumulate, non-existence appears. The childish, through their active construction and accumulation, have existence appear for them. The wise, through not actively constructing and accumulating, have non-existence appear for them. The middle between what exists and what does not exist — that is the domain of the noble ones. What is the domain of the noble ones is not the domain of those who are not noble."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, what does the term 'noble one' indicate?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, the term 'noble one' refers to the ground in which all that is without dust and without affliction is perfectly gathered."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, is there a synonym by which all phenomena, being without dust and without affliction, are perfectly gathered together?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, there is."

Subhūti said: "What is that synonym?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, it is like this: just as all the waters of the great ocean flow perfectly together into one, sharing a single taste — the taste of salt — so too all the qualities of a buddha, being without dust and without affliction, are perfectly gathered together, sharing a single taste — the taste of liberation."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, from what is one to be liberated, that liberation is taught?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, what do you think? If something existed, would bondage arise?"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, if ignorance existed, bondage would arise."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, therefore liberation is taught in order to free one from ignorance."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, if there is no distinction to be made among all phenomena, how can knowing or not knowing be taught?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, it is like this: water warmed by the heat of spring is taught as warm. That same water in the cold season is taught as cold."

Yet there is not the slightest distinction to be made in that water itself. In just the same way, Venerable Subhūti, the mind heated by inappropriate attention is taught as ignorance, and appropriate attention is taught as knowing. Yet within that, there is nothing whatsoever taught as the knowing or not knowing of any inner agent acting."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter is difficult to understand."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, it is so for those who dwell in duality."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter is difficult to see."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, it is so for those who lack the eye of wisdom."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter is difficult to fathom."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, it is so for those who have not found the depth."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter is difficult to know."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, it is so for those possessed of excessive pride."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter is difficult to comprehend."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, it is so for those who lack the limbs of awakening."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter is difficult to have confidence in."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, it is so for those who take delight in the ground of all."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter cannot be examined."

Mañjuśrī said: "It is so, for in it no characteristics arise anywhere at all."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter is not within the domain of logical reasoning."

Mañjuśrī said: "It is so, for in it there is no individual discernment."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter is supremely noble."

Mañjuśrī said: "It is so, for it is free from the perception of dedication."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, this matter is known by those who are learned and wise."

Mañjuśrī said: "It is so, for it is known through oneself."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, when the Tathāgata said, 'Ultimately, the aim is not an aim,' what was the intended meaning of those words?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, what is called 'the aim' is an aim that is inexpressible. Those who engage with an aim that can be expressed — their aim is not the aim. Therefore the Blessed One declared, 'Ultimately, that aim is not an aim.'

"Furthermore, Venerable Subhūti, what is called 'the aim' is an aim of solitude. Those who engage with an aim that is associated with body, speech, and mind — their aim is not the aim. Therefore the Blessed One also declared, 'Ultimately, the aim is not an aim.'"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, with what intention did the Blessed One declare, 'All phenomena are not phenomena'?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, the Blessed One declared it in this sense: those who understand the categories of the Dharma to be like a raft should abandon even the nature of reality itself — how much more so what is not the Dharma. And that which is to be abandoned should not be called either 'a phenomenon' or 'not a phenomenon.'"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, are even the qualities of a buddha not phenomena?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, among the qualities of a buddha there is not anything whatsoever that is truly established. And what is not truly established cannot be called either 'a phenomenon' or 'not a phenomenon.' Therefore the Blessed One declared, 'All phenomena are not phenomena.'"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, it is wonderful that bodhisattvas at the beginning stage, upon hearing this teaching, do not become frightened, terrified, or dismayed."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, what do you think? If a hundred lion cubs hear the roar of a lion, would they be frightened, terrified, or dismayed? And if the offspring of the king of geese, soaring in the midst of the sky, hears the call of a goose, would they be frightened, terrified, or dismayed?"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, no — a lion cub is not frightened by its own sound, and the offspring of the king of geese is not frightened by what is within its own domain."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, just so, a bodhisattva born from the lineage and family of the Tathāgata, who has emerged through suchness and emptiness, is not frightened, terrified, or dismayed by any phenomenon, any sound, or any teaching whatsoever. Yet, Venerable Subhūti, do you know what it is, when it exists, that causes fright?"

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, when the view of the transitory collection exists, there is fright."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, a bodhisattva thoroughly understands that view of the transitory collection, and therefore is not frightened by any phenomenon, not frightened, terrified, or dismayed by any sound or any teaching."

Subhūti said:

"Mañjuśrī, if a bodhisattva thoroughly understands the view of the transitory collection, why does he not attain the fruit?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, a bodhisattva thoroughly understands the view of the transitory collection not because he wishes to attain the fruit — for he is to remain in equanimity with respect to attaining the fruit — but rather because he wishes to attain the qualities of a buddha, and so, being engaged with great compassion toward all sentient beings, the bodhisattva thoroughly understands the view of the transitory collection, and therefore does not attain the fruit."

Subhūti said: "Mañjuśrī, that skillful means of the bodhisattva — whereby the bodhisattva thoroughly understands the view of the transitory collection and yet does not attain the fruit — that is truly great skillful means."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, it is thus: the wisdom-expanse of the bodhisattva is perfectly held by skillful means and wisdom. Therefore that bodhisattva thoroughly understands the view of the transitory collection and yet does not attain the fruit.

"Venerable Subhūti, consider this example: when a great and mighty man cuts down a great sāla tree with a sharp weapon, it is severed clean through, yet it remains standing right there and does not fall.

"Venerable Subhūti, in the same way, the wisdom-expanse of the bodhisattva is perfectly held by skillful means and wisdom. Therefore that bodhisattva thoroughly understands the view of the transitory collection and yet does not attain the fruit.

"Venerable Subhūti, when that great sāla tree is soaked and moistened by a great rainfall, there comes a time and an occasion when it grows again and puts forth branches, leaves, flowers, and fruits, nourishing all sentient beings.

"Venerable Subhūti, in the same way, the bodhisattva who is soaked and moistened by great loving-kindness and great compassion thoroughly understands the view of the transitory collection, is yet born again in the three realms, and manifests a life, a lineage, and a birth through which all sentient beings are nourished.

"Venerable Subhūti, there is also a time and an occasion when that great sāla tree, struck by the force of a great wind, falls to the ground.

"Venerable Subhūti, in the same way, when struck by the force of the wind of great wisdom, a bodhisattva falls, dissolving into the essence of awakening."

Then the Blessed One praised Mañjuśrī, the youthful, with the words "Excellent!" and declared: "Mañjuśrī, you have explained well this teaching on the wisdom-expanse of the bodhisattvas — perfectly held by skillful means and wisdom — and on the qualities of great loving-kindness and great compassion. Excellent! Well done!

"Mañjuśrī, I too shall now present examples through which the skillful means and wisdom of a bodhisattva may be understood. Listen well.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: a powerful nāga king, by the power of his intention, sends forth from a single mass of cloud both the nature of rain and garlands of lightning, and also sends forth a continuous stream of water bearing the nature of generation and growth.

"Mañjuśrī, in the same way, from a single cloud of skillful means, wisdom, and primordial gnosis, a bodhisattva also displays the conduct of all ordinary childlike beings in order to bring all ordinary childlike sentient beings to full maturation, and also displays the conduct of all noble ones in order to tame those sentient beings who are to be tamed.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: on the king of mountains, the Himālayas, there grows a fragrant tree. The fragrance of its root is one thing, the fragrance of its trunk is another,

the fragrance of its branches is another, the fragrance of its leaves is another, the fragrance of its flowers is another, and the fragrance of its fruit is yet another. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, the body of a bodhisattva who is like a

fragrant tree releases the fragrance of Dharma in its own fitting way according to the aspirations of each sentient being, and yet never stirs from the fragrance of the root, which is great compassion.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: there is a precious jewel in the possession of Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods). When that precious jewel is worn at the throat of Śakra, lord of the gods, it displays all the dwellings of the Trāyastriṃśa heaven, all the joys of Śakra lord of the gods, and all his retinues of amusement — and yet the precious jewel itself entertains no conceptual thought whatsoever. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, the expanse of primordial wisdom of a bodhisattva who is like a pure precious jewel displays all activities, and yet throughout all of that is entirely free of conceptual thought.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: there is a precious jewel called the wish-fulfilling gem. It perfectly fulfills the wishes of all sentient beings just as they desire, and yet that precious jewel entertains no conceptual thought whatsoever. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva of pure superior intention who is like a precious jewel perfectly fulfills the wishes of all sentient beings just as they desire, and yet that bodhisattva entertains no conceptual thought whatsoever.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: in space, fire blazes and rain falls, yet in space itself there is no heat and there is no becoming cold. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva of skillful means dwells within the three realms that blaze with affliction and also moves within the peace of nirvāṇa, yet has no heat and undergoes no becoming cold.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: in space, poisonous trees grow and medicinal trees grow, yet space itself is not afflicted by the poisonous trees and is not purified by the medicinal trees. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva of skillful means carries aggregates (skandhas) that are like poisonous trees, and also carries faculties that are like medicinal trees, yet is not afflicted by the afflictions of the aggregates and is not purified by the pure faculties, and performs the function of both.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: a water vessel has a hundred holes. When one hole is stopped up, water does not leak from any of them. When one hole is opened, water leaks from all of them. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, when a bodhisattva is in meditative equipoise, they perfect the great superknowledges without any outflow toward objects. Then, upon rising from that equipoise, they flow out to all objects in order to teach Dharma to all sentient beings each in the way that is fitting for them.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: a supremely powerful excellent horse called Cāṅgśes guards its rider, but does not do so for itself. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, supremely powerful bodhisattvas who have attained great compassion guard all sentient beings, but do not do so for themselves.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: the lion, king of the beasts, fears nothing whatsoever except blazing fire. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva fears nothing whatsoever except falling to the level of a śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: the king of yaks, the son of Sasruṅ, belongs to the class of animals, yet it displays all the joys and amusements appropriate to each of the gods of the Trāyastriṃśa heaven and to Śakra, lord of the gods, so that they may accumulate merit. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva, even having gone to an animal rebirth, in that very state —

displays all the Dharma teachings appropriate to each sentient being, so as to bring them fully to ripening.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: fire born from a fire-drill and fire born from a precious gem — both equally have the nature of heat. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, the bodhisattva who first arouses the mind and the bodhisattva who arouses the final mind while seated at the seat of awakening — both equally have the nature of burning away the afflictions of sentient beings.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: the many kinds of fragrant trees all arise having been fully embraced by the four elements. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, all the various accumulations of virtuous roots gathered by bodhisattvas arise when they are fully embraced by the awakening mind and dedicated toward omniscience.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: wherever the precious wheel of a wheel-turning king goes, the entire host of that king's armies follows. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, wherever the Perfection of Wisdom endowed with skillful means of a bodhisattva goes, all the qualities on the side of awakening of that bodhisattva follow.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: the chick of the kalavinka, king of birds, while still within the egg — though the egg is not yet cracked and it has not yet emerged from the shell — nonetheless sings out the very sweet and beautiful song of the kalavinka. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva who has entered within the shell of the egg of ignorance, who has not yet shattered the view of the transitory collection, who has not yet emerged from the three realms — nonetheless proclaims the sounds of emptiness, of signlessness, of

wishlessness, of non-construction, and of the buddha's Dharma.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: when the kalavinka is among peacocks, it does not sing the kalavinka's song; but when it is among other kalavinka birds, it sings the kalavinka's song. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, when a bodhisattva is among śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, it does not proclaim the inconceivable sound of the Dharma of a buddha; but when it is among bodhisattvas, it proclaims the inconceivable sound of the Dharma of a buddha.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: the scattered wind cannot be contained by the trees, buildings, palaces, or regions of Jambudvīpa. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, when bodhisattvas fully proclaim the inconceivable Dharma qualities of a buddha, those śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas who have not been blessed by the blessing of a buddha cannot have faith in or trust it; but those who have been blessed by the blessing of a buddha can indeed have faith and conviction.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: the light of the sun shines on both the clean and the unclean, yet it does not become attached to the clean, nor does it become angry at the unclean — the orb of the sun is beyond all such description. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, the rays of a bodhisattva's wisdom shine upon śrāvakas and ordinary beings alike, yet the bodhisattva does not become attached to śrāvakas, nor does it become angry at ordinary beings — a bodhisattva is beyond all such description.

"Mañjuśrī, consider this: when the Pārijāta tree of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three sheds all its leaves and becomes bare, the gods of the Thirty-Three, without long delay, rejoice, thinking: 'Soon this Pārijāta tree will be adorned with flowers and fruit again.'

Mañjuśrī, in the same way, whenever a bodhisattva gives away all his possessions entirely, without long delay the buddha bhagavāns will praise him, saying: "Before long, this bodhisattva will bestow upon all sentient beings the flowers and fruit of the Buddha's Dharma."

Mañjuśrī, consider this: trees that are bent by the wind, bent all the way over, bent right down to the ground, have no fear of being toppled. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, bodhisattvas who bow to all sentient beings, bow fully, bow down completely, have no fear of falling into the ground of śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: water always flows to wherever the land is low. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva who is free of pride flows straight to

the place of omniscience.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: when the great ocean first settles, it comes to rest first in the lowest part of all the great earth, and then all the streams of flowing water flow into it there without effort. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, for the bodhisattva who is free of pride, all the qualities of the Buddha's Dharma everywhere and in all respects become directly manifest with ease.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: a vajra (adamantine gem) can pierce through all precious jewels, yet that vajra gem itself cannot be pierced by them. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva tames śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, yet does not fall into the ground of being tamed by them.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: when the Māndārava flower is stirred by the wind, its fragrance spreads in all directions for a hundred leagues around. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, when a bodhisattva is stirred by noble wisdom, the fragrance of great loving-kindness and great compassion pervades all sentient beings.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: those who anoint themselves with the fragrance of the Māndārava flower are not afflicted by any sickness. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, those who anoint themselves with the fragrance of a bodhisattva's great loving-kindness and great compassion will not be overpowered by any sickness of affliction.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: if no buddha arises, the Udumbara flower does not appear. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, if the awakening mind (bodhicitta) is not aroused, the flowers of the Buddha's qualities will not appear either.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: when Anavatapta, the nāga king, sends down rain, he sends it down pervading all of Jambudvīpa. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, when a bodhisattva sends down the rain of the sacred Dharma, it falls equally upon the mental streams of all sentient beings.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: from the great lake Anavatapta flow four great rivers, which fill the four great oceans completely. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, a bodhisattva, through the flow of the four means of gathering disciples, completely fills the great ocean of wisdom.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: if the great ocean did not exist, the people of Jambudvīpa would have no access to precious jewels. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, if no buddha were to arise, all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas would have no access to the precious Dharma of liberation.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: whatever forms there may be, all of them are wholly held together by the four great elements. Mañjuśrī, in the same way, whatever qualities of a bodhisattva there may be, all of them are wholly held together by the four blessings. Mañjuśrī, consider this:

Consider this, Mañjuśrī: a medicinal tree growing in a dangerous and frightening ravine does not bring benefit to many people. In the same way, Mañjuśrī, śrāvakas who dwell in the terrifying ravine of fear of saṃsāra do not bring benefit to many people.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: a medicinal tree growing within a city does bring benefit to many people. In the same way, Mañjuśrī, a bodhisattva who has entered into the heart of great loving-kindness and great compassion, and who arouses the mind oriented toward omniscience, will bring benefit to all sentient beings.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: those springs that arise in summer do not persist for long. In the same way, Mañjuśrī, the Dharma taught by śrāvakas does not persist for long.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: a spring that arises in springtime does persist for long. In the same way, Mañjuśrī, the Dharma taught by bodhisattvas does persist for long.

Mañjuśrī, consider this: trees on Himavat, the king of mountains, when cut down, quickly grow back again. In the same way, Mañjuśrī, even when a Tathāgata has completed his work and passed into nirvāṇa, the line of the Three Jewels does not come to an end.

Then the venerable Subhūti addressed the Blessed One in these words: Blessed One, it is wondrous that the Tathāgata has spoken in such a way, praising the genuine qualities of bodhisattvas whose qualities are beyond measure and are worthy of praise. Blessed One, it is supremely wondrous that those bodhisattvas, upon hearing such genuine praises of their qualities, neither become joyful nor become proud.

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, all those bodhisattvas are pure at the root. Because their genuine qualities are spoken of and praised, they neither become joyful nor become proud.

Subhūti asked: Blessed One, from what root are bodhisattvas pure?

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, bodhisattvas are pure from the root of no-self, from the root of there being no sentient being, no living soul, no

life-force, no person, from the root of the view of the transitory collection, from the root of ignorance and craving for existence, and from the root of what is called "I" and "mine."

Subhūti asked: Blessed One, what does the word "pure" indicate?

The Blessed One declared: It means neither grasped nor released — and therefore it is called "pure." Neither arisen nor ceased, neither examined nor fully examined, neither drawn out nor placed in, neither made nor constructed, not darkness, not light, not afflicted, not purified, not bound, not liberated, not saṃsāra, not nirvāṇa — therefore it is called "pure."

Subhūti asked: Blessed One, if it is neither saṃsāra nor nirvāṇa, then what is this purity?

The Blessed One declared: Subhūti, this very state — having no conceit regarding nirvāṇa and no clinging to saṃsāra — is what is called purity here.

Subhūti, consider this: although space is spoken of as "pure," space is in fact neither pure nor afflicted, and yet space is called "pure." In the same way, Subhūti, although nirvāṇa is spoken of as "pure," nirvāṇa is in fact neither pure nor afflicted, and yet nirvāṇa is called "pure."

Subhūti, what do you think?

"What do you think is pure?" Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, when there is no affliction whatsoever, at that time I am pure."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, what then is your purity that is free from affliction?"

Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, the dharmadhātu is pure by its very intrinsic nature. Because I have fully realized that, I am thereby fully pure."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, can the dharmadhātu be fully known?"

Subhūti replied: "Blessed One, if there were some other phenomenon apart from the dharmadhātu, then that other phenomenon might seek out the dharmadhātu. But the dharmadhātu itself cannot seek out the dharmadhātu."

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, if there is no phenomenon apart from the dharmadhātu by which the dharmadhātu can be fully known, then how do you fully know the dharmadhātu?"

When that was declared, the venerable Subhūti fell silent and said nothing.

The Second Fascicle.

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, said this to the venerable Subhūti, who had fallen silent: "Noble Subhūti, why have you stopped short of answering the question the Blessed One posed to you?"

Subhūti replied: "Mañjuśrī, for as long as one has not yet entered upon unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, at that time I remain seated — for hearers' confidence is obstructed and impeded, while bodhisattvas' confidence is unobstructed and unimpeded."

Mañjuśrī said: "But Noble Subhūti, do you perceive any obstruction or impediment whatsoever in the dharmadhātu?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, that is not the case. No obstruction or impediment is perceived in the dharmadhātu."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then why has the venerable Subhūti been impeded in his speaking?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, those who fully know the dharmadhātu by way of a bounded and delimited approach find their speaking impeded. But those who fully know the dharmadhātu by way of an immeasurable approach are not interrupted in their speaking."

Mañjuśrī said: "Noble Subhūti, is there any boundary or limit at all in the dharmadhātu?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, that is not the case. The dharmadhātu is the gateway of all — there is no boundary or limit whatsoever in the dharmadhātu."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then why does the venerable Subhūti present the dharmadhātu as bounded and limited?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, taking the domain of hearers as the measure, I present the dharmadhātu as bounded. Taking the domain of buddhas as the measure, I present the dharmadhātu as immeasurable."

Mañjuśrī said: "Noble Subhūti, does the dharmadhātu arise from an object?"

Subhūti replied: "Mañjuśrī, the dharmadhātu does not arise from an object — for the dharmadhātu has no object; it is free from any object."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then why does the venerable Subhūti present it as distinct objects?"

Subhūti replied: "Mañjuśrī, did I not say at the very outset that hearers' confidence is obstructed and impeded, while bodhisattvas' confidence is

unobstructed and unimpeded?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Noble Subhūti, have you not attained individual perfect knowledge?"

Subhūti replied: "Mañjuśrī, I have attained individual perfect knowledge."

Mañjuśrī said:

"Then why does the venerable Subhūti's teaching become obstructed?"

Subhūti replied: "Mañjuśrī, the individual perfect knowledge of hearers is devoid of knowing the superior and inferior faculties of sentient beings. That is why the teaching becomes obstructed. The individual perfect knowledge of bodhisattvas, however, is produced by knowing the superior and inferior faculties of all sentient beings. That is why the teaching does not become obstructed."

Mañjuśrī said: "Is the expanse of gnosis by which the gnosis of the venerable Subhūti's individual perfect knowledge is produced — is that expanse of gnosis itself characterized by obstruction?"

Subhūti replied: "Mañjuśrī, it is not. The expanse of gnosis is characterized by unobstructedness; it is by nature without obstruction."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Subhūti, if the expanse of gnosis is characterized by unobstructedness and is by nature without obstruction, then why does the teaching become obstructed?"

Subhūti replied: "Mañjuśrī, the venerable Śāriputra has been proclaimed by the Blessed One to be supreme among hearers in the greatness of wisdom. Ask him — he will explain this to you."

The venerable Śāriputra said: "Let the venerable Subhūti himself speak. As for me, I wish to listen to the teaching being taught by Mañjuśrī in his youthful form — I have no wish to teach it. And why? Because I have seen with my own eyes that when this Mañjuśrī in his youthful form teaches the Dharma in the presence of many hundreds of thousands of buddhas, even the great hearers fall silent and say nothing."

Then the venerable Subhūti, gazing toward the east across many hundreds of thousands of buddha fields, perceived a world system called Luminous, and dwelling there a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha named Summit of Light, presently living, present, and teaching the Dharma. In that world there was a great hearer called Lamp of Wisdom, proclaimed by

that Blessed One to be supreme among hearers in the greatness of wisdom.

When the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha Summit of Light, had entered into the equanimity of the night, the great hearer Lamp of Wisdom passed beyond the Brahma world and, intending to teach the Dharma to the entire great trichiliocosm (Skt. trisāhasramahāsāhasralokadhātu), he taught the Dharma throughout it. Both I and Mañjuśrī in his youthful form also went to that world system, and moreover many hundreds of thousands of bodhisattvas and many hundreds of thousands of divine sons, wishing to hear the Dharma, followed after Mañjuśrī in his youthful form.

Then Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, seated in the class of the gods of Clear Light, let out a cry — the cry of clearing one's throat — of such a kind that the entire great trichiliocosm resounded with its sound and all the abodes of Māra were shaken to their foundations. When the great hearer heard that sound, unable to bear its force, he fell to the ground like a bird struck down by a scatter-wind, and was seized with alarm, his hair standing on end. Overcome with wonder, he went directly to where the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha Summit of Light, was, and having bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet in homage, he addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, who was it that produced this profound sound of clearing the throat — a sound of such a kind that, unable to bear its force, I fell to the ground like a bird struck down by a scatter-wind?"

The Blessed One declared: "Monk, the bodhisattva called Mañjuśrī the Youthful — a non-returner, a being of one more birth — came to this world-realm by the power of his unattached miraculous ability, in order to see me, to pay homage, to render honor, to make inquiry, and to make thorough inquiry. Mañjuśrī the Youthful, abiding in the divine realm of luminosity, produced that sound of clearing the throat which caused the entire great trichiliocosm to resound and all the abodes of Māra to be shaken to their foundations."

The monk replied: "Blessed One, it would be excellent to see such a noble being. We too would behold Mañjuśrī the Youthful."

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha Summit of Light, made a sign in order to summon Mañjuśrī the Youthful.

Thereupon Mañjuśrī the Youthful descended from the intermediate sky together with those bodhisattvas and those divine sons, approached the place where the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha Summit of Light was, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet in homage, and circumambulated the Blessed One three times. Then, together with his retinue, he took his place to one side upon a seat conjured in accordance with his own aspiration and by the power of his miraculous ability.

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha Summit of Light, addressed Mañjuśrī the Youthful with these words:

"Mañjuśrī, with what purpose in view have you come to this world-realm with its inhabitants?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "It was in order to see the Blessed One, to pay homage, to render honor, to make inquiry, and to make thorough inquiry."

The Blessed One declared: "Mañjuśrī, in what manner does beholding a Tathāgata become utterly pure? In what manner does paying homage to a Tathāgata become genuine? In what manner does rendering honor become genuine? In what manner does making inquiry become genuine? In what manner does making thorough inquiry become genuine?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, when beholding phenomena is utterly pure in such a way — that is utterly pure beholding of a Tathāgata. Blessed One, when one neither bows down with body nor with mind, does not prostrate and there is no performing of prostration, dwells free from timidity, has attained imperturbability, conducts oneself in the manner of mental solitude, and acts with mindfulness and vigilance — such is paying genuine homage to the Tathāgata. Blessed One, when one does not superimpose selfhood, does not superimpose otherness, does not treat sameness as sameness, does not treat difference as difference, and there is no performing and no elaborating of such acts; when one has become of one conduct with the buddhas, the blessed ones; when one follows in the way of the body of a buddha and the dharmakāya; when one sees one's own body as having entered into the dharmadhātu; when, in seeing, one does not see it as a seeing; when one does not see wrongly; when one becomes neither remote from anything nor near to it — such is rendering genuine honor to the Tathāgata."

"Blessed One, it is not that one petitions improperly — rather, one petitions properly. What is improper is to perceive nothing at all correctly, and then to

follow after the proper mode of all phenomena with a distracted mind. One petitions in meditative equipoise. When the one who petitions, the purpose for which one petitions, and the one to whom one petitions are sought throughout the three times and found to be pure — when the three spheres are utterly pure — such is what it means to have made a thorough petition to the Tathāgata.

Blessed One, when one does not arrogantly take oneself to have understood what has been petitioned; when one acts in accord with what has been declared; when one pleases the Tathāgata; when one gladdens the entire retinue; when one is without attachment to the petitioning itself; and when, through that very petitioning, one clothes countless sentient beings in the armor of awakening — and does not cast off that armor until one reaches the very heart of awakening — such is what it means to have petitioned the Tathāgata thoroughly and well."

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha Pinnacle of Light, said "Excellent!" to Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, and spoke: "Mañjuśrī, the Tathāgata is to be viewed in just this way, to be revered in just this way, to be honored in just this way, to be petitioned in just this way, and to be petitioned thoroughly and well in just this way." And as for what you yourself have said — that is well spoken. Excellent! Excellent!"

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī said this to the great śrāvaka Prajñādīpa: "Venerable one, how do you view the Tathāgata? How do you pay homage? How do you render honor? How do you petition? How do you petition thoroughly and well?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, a teaching such as this is not the domain of śrāvakas like us, who follow after the words of others."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then by what realization is the mind of the venerable Prajñādīpa liberated?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, the mind is liberated by the direct realization of truth."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable one, what does the word 'truth' indicate?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, that which is distinguished by having no antidote — that is truth."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then how is it that the venerable one's mind is liberated through the direct realization of truth?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, it is taught by taking hold of the conventional, and not by way of the ultimate."

Mañjuśrī said: "Does the conventional then gather into the ultimate?"

He replied: "If it did not, the ultimate would be entirely absent."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then how is it that one teaches by taking hold of the conventional and yet it is not ultimate? If the conventional gathers into the ultimate, would it not be the case that truth is single — merely one — in the ultimate truth?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, if beginning bodhisattvas were to hear this explanation, they would be terrified."

Mañjuśrī said: "If even the venerable one himself would be terrified, what need is there to speak of beginning bodhisattvas?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, it is impossible to make me terrified."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable one, is it that you are free from the defilements — your mind liberated from the outflows — by reason of being without terror and without weariness, and hence without clinging?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, śrāvakas are not liberated by being without terror and without weariness."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable one, therefore, bearing in mind precisely that former terror, when you said that even the venerable one himself would be terrified — what need is there then to speak of beginning bodhisattvas? It was in that sense that you spoke those words."

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, how is a bodhisattva liberated?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable one, a bodhisattva is liberated by being without terror and without weariness."

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, with what in mind do you say so?"

He replied:

"One is without terror at a hundred thousand divisions of Māra's armies, and without weariness at teaching the Dharma to sentient beings. One is without terror at having accumulated immeasurable accumulations of merit, and without weariness at having accumulated immeasurable accumulations of wisdom."

Then the gods' sons assembled in that retinue scattered various flowers upon Mañjuśrī, the youthful one. Wherever Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, appears, there a Tathāgata is seen directly. The very ground where Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, abides also becomes a sacred shrine. Those sentient beings who fully know, or who will come to fully know, the Dharma as taught by Mañjuśrī, the youthful one — they too have wholly embraced all merit. So saying, these words were spoken.

Then once again Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, addressed the great śrāvaka Prajñādīpa with these words: "Venerable one, since the Blessed One has declared you to be supreme among śrāvakas in greatness of wisdom, tell me — does that wisdom bear the defining mark of the conditioned, or the defining mark of the unconditioned? If it bears the defining mark of the conditioned, then it would be subject to arising and ceasing. But if it bears the defining mark of the unconditioned, then it would be excluded from the three defining marks."

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, noble ones demonstrate the differentiation by means of the unconditioned."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable one, is it possible to designate something as unconditioned?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, no — there is no designation whatsoever for the unconditioned."

Mañjuśrī said: "Then how do noble ones demonstrate the differentiation by means of the unconditioned?"

At these words, the great śrāvaka Prajñādīpa fell silent and said nothing.

Then the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened buddha Raśmīketu declared to Mañjuśrī, the youthful one: "Mañjuśrī, compose some gateway to the Dharma, the hearing of which will render a bodhisattva, a great being, irreversible from the unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, and teach it here to this assembly."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Blessed One, all the teachings of all the gateways to phenomena are gateways of solitude, for those gateways of solitude themselves reveal solitude."

Now at that time a bodhisattva named Dharmamati was seated there in that assembly, and he said to Mañjuśrī, the youthful one: "Mañjuśrī, are those teachings on attachment, aversion, and delusion that the Tathāgata has given

— are they themselves gateways of solitude that reveal solitude?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Good son, what do you think? From where do attachment, aversion, and delusion arise?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, attachment, aversion, and delusion arise from thought and conceptual thought."

Mañjuśrī said: "Good son, and from where does that thought and conceptual thought arise?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, thought and conceptual thought arise from inverted views."

Mañjuśrī said: "Good son, and from where do inverted views arise?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, inverted views arise from grasping at I and grasping at mine."

Mañjuśrī said: "Good son, and from where do grasping at I and grasping at mine arise?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, grasping at I and grasping at mine arise from the view of the transitory collection."

Mañjuśrī said: "Good son, and from where does the view of the transitory collection arise?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, the view of the transitory collection arises from the self."

Mañjuśrī said: "Good son, and from where does the self arise?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, the self has not arisen from anywhere. That very non-arising is the arising of the self. Why is that?"

"For the self, searched for throughout the ten directions, is nowhere to be found."

Mañjuśrī said: "Good son, what is the gateway to those phenomena that are nowhere found even when searched for throughout the ten directions?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, solitude itself is that gateway."

Mañjuśrī said: "Good son, what is the gateway of solitude?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, the very absence of a gateway is the gateway of solitude."

Mañjuśrī said: "Good son, reflecting on that, I say this: all the teachings on the gateways of all phenomena are the gateway of solitude — they all teach that solitude itself is the gateway."

When this teaching was given, eight hundred bodhisattvas attained acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti).

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī, having taught the Dharma at length, rose from his seat and departed.

The Venerable Subhūti said: "If not even a single śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha is capable of interrupting the flow of eloquence of the youthful Mañjuśrī, how could the likes of us, who have not opened that door, possibly speak in the presence of the youthful Mañjuśrī?"

Then the Venerable Subhūti said this to the Venerable Śāriputra: "Venerable Śāriputra, when the youthful Mañjuśrī was ranging through buddha-fields, how many displays of miraculous power and wondrous transformation did you witness?"

Śāriputra replied: "Venerable Subhūti, I directly perceived the following: wherever the youthful Mañjuśrī passed as he ranged through the buddha-fields, those buddha-fields that had been scorched became utterly filled with water and adorned with a multitude of lotuses. Those that had been filled with water became filled with fire, yet that fire, to the touch, was like heartwood of sandalwood serpent-wood or like cloth woven from kacalindi fiber. Those that had been empty sky became filled with bodhisattvas dwelling in the palaces of Brahmā and absorbed in meditative concentration. Those that were crumbling appeared to be falling to ruin. Those that were filled with lower states of existence appeared free of all lower states, and the sentient beings in them attained a loving-kindness arisen from the aspects of the limbs of awakening. What is this loving-kindness arisen from the aspects of the limbs of awakening? It is the loving-kindness in whose meditative absorption one fully and perfectly awakens to unsurpassed and perfect awakening, and in which one thinks: 'I shall teach the Dharma for the sake of sentient beings tormented by the afflictions of attachment, aversion, and delusion, so that their attachment, aversion, and delusion may be thoroughly abandoned.' The entry into the meditative absorption of loving-kindness in just that way is called loving-kindness arisen from the aspects of the limbs of awakening.

"Venerable Subhūti, at that very moment a thought arose in my mind — that the miraculous power of the youthful Mañjuśrī and my own miraculous power

were equal. But the youthful Mañjuśrī, knowing that conceptual thought of my mind, appeared in the midst of this great trichilocosm as it blazed with fire, and said to me: 'Should this world-system be crossed by the miraculous power of the Venerable Śāriputra, or should it be crossed by my miraculous power?' And I replied to him thus:"

"It should be crossed by the swiftness of my own miraculous power." Venerable Subhūti, I then displayed all the miraculous feats born of the swiftness of my miraculous power, extinguished the fire within a radius of about one fathom all around, and together with the youthful Mañjuśrī crossed that world-system in seven days.

Then on another occasion, in a world-system far vaster and more expansive than that, when fire was blazing, the youthful Mañjuśrī appeared in the midst of that world and said to me: "Venerable Śāriputra, whose miraculous power shall be used to cross this world-system?" I replied to him thus: "Mañjuśrī, let it be crossed by the force of your miraculous power." Thereupon the youthful Mañjuśrī, by raising a single thought of directly manifest miraculous power, covered that entire world-system with a net of lotuses and crossed it. Having crossed, he said to me: "Venerable Śāriputra, between the two of us, whose miraculous power moves more swiftly?" I replied to him thus: "Mañjuśrī, what do you think? Between a common fowl (gulika) and the king of birds, Garuḍa, whose power moves more swiftly?" He said: "Venerable Śāriputra, the swiftness of Garuḍa's power is immeasurable and cannot easily be taken as an example." To that I said: "Mañjuśrī, my own miraculous swiftness should be regarded as being like the swiftness of a common fowl. Your miraculous power, on the other hand, should be regarded as exceeding even the swiftness of Garuḍa a hundredfold, a thousandfold, and far beyond." Then he said: "Venerable Śāriputra, did you not form the conceptual thought that the miraculous power of the youthful Mañjuśrī and my own miraculous power were equal?" I replied to him: "Mañjuśrī, it is just as you have said — I did think that." He said: "Why did you think that?" I replied to him thus: "Hearers, because the continuity of their habitual tendencies has not been severed, may remain unequal, yet I knew myself to be equal." He said: "Excellent, Venerable Śāriputra! Excellent! It is exactly as you have said. And why? Venerable Śāriputra, in the past, at a time long gone by, there dwelt beside a great ocean two sages, one named Dharmecchu, 'Desiring the Dharma,' and one named Kunadin, 'Fully Endowed.' Of these, Dharmecchu had five supernormal powers and took delight in displaying them. Kunadin, by the power of his knowledge

and mantras, was able to travel through the middle of the sky. From time to time, for the sake of their activities, those two would cross from the near shore of the ocean to the far shore, and having crossed, would return and settle each in his own abode. Then the sage Kunadin formed the thought that his own miraculous power and that of Dharmecchu were equal.

"Then on another occasion, while crossing from the near shore of the ocean to the far shore, they arrived at the island of the rākṣasīs. There the sage Kunadin heard those rākṣasīs producing the sounds of pleasing music, and saw them as well — whereupon he fell from the middle of the sky down to the earth. His knowledge and his mantras too became ineffectual. Then the sage Dharmecchu, stirred by a mind of compassion, took him by the right hand, led him back to their own abode, and set him down there.

"Venerable Śāriputra, do you have any doubt or uncertainty that the sage Dharmecchu of that time and that occasion was someone other than myself? Do not look at it that way. Why? Because I myself was the one who, at that time and on that occasion, was known as the sage Dharmecchu. Venerable Śāriputra, do you have any doubt or uncertainty that the sage Kunadin of that time and that occasion was someone other than yourself? Do not look at it that way. Why? Because you yourself were the one who, at that time and on that occasion, was known as the sage Kunadin. And, venerable Śāriputra, even then I placed you, who were unequal to me, as my equal. Just so, because you are endowed with a wisdom that is of one orientation, even now I have placed you, though still unequal, as my equal."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra spoke further to the venerable Subhūti, saying: "Venerable Subhūti, I have come to know through direct cognition that once, while traveling together with Mañjuśrī the youthful through buddha-fields to the south, having passed beyond many hundreds of thousands of millions of buddha-fields, we arrived at a world-realm called Adorned with All Ornaments. There, in the buddha-field of the Blessed One the Tathāgata known as Precious Life-Tree, we went in order to behold, pay homage to, and venerate that Blessed One. Then Mañjuśrī the youthful said this to me: 'Venerable Śāriputra, do you see those buddha-fields we have passed through?' I replied to him: 'Mañjuśrī, I see them.' He then said: 'Venerable Śāradvatīputra, what are those buddha-fields like, as you see them?' I replied to him as follows: 'Some are entirely filled with fire. Some are entirely filled with water. Some have become open space. Some are abundant and flourishing. Some are in a state of destruction. Some are in a state of

formation. Some are entirely filled with lower destinies. And some are entirely free of lower destinies.' He then said: 'Venerable Śāradvatīputra, how should those buddha-fields be viewed?' I replied to him: 'Those that are entirely filled with fire should be viewed simply as entirely filled with fire. Those that are entirely filled with water should be viewed simply as entirely filled with water. Those that have become open space should be viewed simply as having become open space. Those that are abundant and flourishing should be viewed simply as abundant and flourishing. Those that are in a state of destruction should be viewed simply as in a state of destruction. Those that are in a state of formation should be viewed simply as in a state of formation. Those that are entirely filled with lower destinies should be viewed simply as entirely filled with lower destinies. And those that are entirely free of lower destinies should be viewed simply as entirely free of lower destinies.' He then said: 'Venerable Śāradvatīputra, what you have described is precisely what falls within the domain of your wisdom.' I then asked him: 'Mañjuśrī, how do you yourself see those buddha-fields?' He replied: 'Venerable Śāradvatīputra, I see all buddha-fields as the field of space. Why? Because whatever is entirely filled with fire, or entirely filled with water, or abundant and flourishing, or in a state of destruction, or in a state of formation, or entirely filled with lower destinies, or entirely free of lower destinies — all of that is not ultimate. Those conditions arise adventitiously; they are subject to arising and disintegration. Space, however, does not arise from conditions — it abides as a matter of intrinsic nature.'"

"In the same way, when the mind becomes afflicted it is said to be afflicted by adventitious defilements — yet the intrinsic nature of mind has never at any time become afflicted. Venerable Śāradvatīputra, consider this analogy: even though, in time gone by, fires blazing for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges occurred, space was never at any time burned. In the same way, Venerable Śāradvatīputra, even though each and every sentient being has accumulated non-virtuous karma as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges, the intrinsic nature of mind has never at any time become afflicted in that way.

Venerable Śāradvatīputra, those sons and daughters of good family who enter into such a dharmadhātu, naturally and thoroughly pure, have not even the slightest arising from defilements, or obscuration, or arousal through formations. This is the gateway to the Dharma of non-arising. Relying upon this gateway to the Dharma, great bodhisattvas, the great beings, enter into

the intrinsic nature of all phenomena as thoroughly pure; they become skilled in distinguishing what arises from fault; and their minds are never obscured by obscuring phenomena.

Venerable Subhūti, of the miraculous displays and Dharma-teaching displays of Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, what I myself have directly witnessed is exactly of this kind."

Then the Venerable Ānanda spoke to the Venerable Śāriputra as follows: "Venerable Śāriputra, I too directly witnessed certain of the miraculous displays of Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma. Venerable Śāriputra, I personally recall that at one time the Blessed One was staying right here in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with a great Saṅgha of eight hundred monks and twelve thousand bodhisattvas. At that time, a great unseasonable cloud appeared over Śrāvastī, and for seven days a mighty unseasonable rain fell without interruption.

Those monks among them who possessed great miraculous powers and great might — who had attained dhyāna, liberations, meditative absorption, and meditative composure — passed their time in dhyāna, liberations, meditative absorption, and meditative composure. But those who had not attained these went without food for those seven days. Those monks, enfeebled and overcome, were unable to go and behold the Blessed One, and so the thought arose in me: 'How distressing! If these monks were to become utterly exhausted, I would go to the Blessed One and report all this to him.' With that thought I went to where the Blessed One was, and when I arrived I bowed my head to the feet of the Blessed One and addressed him thus: 'Blessed One, how distressing — these monks have gone without food for seven days, and, overcome by hunger and enfeebled, they are exhausted; even the effort of rising from their seats and beds and going to behold the Blessed One is beyond them.'

Then the Blessed One said to me: 'Ānanda, go and tell all this to Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma — he will come to the aid of the Saṅgha of monks.' I heeded the Blessed One's words and went to where Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, was staying. At that time Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, was in his own dwelling, together with Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods) and"

Brahma and the world-guardians, teaching the Dharma to them. And Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, saw me enter his dwelling, and upon seeing me said: "Venerable Ānanda, why have you come here in the wind and rain?"

I told Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, everything that had happened. He then said to me: "Ānanda, go and sit in the assembly hall; when the shadow of the gnomon falls at midday, strike the gong." With that, I left the dwelling of Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, and went to the Saṅgha's assembly hall, where I set out a seat. Then, looking toward the dwelling of Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma — wondering whether he had yet come out — I sat down to one side.

Now Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, entered into the meditative absorption called "The Complete Dissolution of the Entire Body," and projected another emanation to teach the Dharma to Śakra, Brahma, and those world-guardians. He himself then came forth from his dwelling; but when he entered the great city of Śrāvastī to gather alms, I did not see him.

At that moment, Māra the Evil One thought to himself: "When this Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, roams through the great city of Śrāvastī gathering alms — like a lion sending forth his roar — I shall ensure that no eye of mine aids him." So thinking, he used his power right then and there to bless things in such a way that not a single brahmin, householder, townsman, or villager in the great city of Śrāvastī could see Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, that no one came forward to greet him, and that no one offered him alms.

Then everywhere Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, went, every door seemed shut against him, and no one came to welcome him.

Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, reflected: "By the blessing of Māra, these brahmins and householders can on no account see me or speak with me." So thinking, he made this declaration of truth: "By whatever truth there is, by truthful words, and by whatever accumulations of merit and wisdom are such that the mass of merit born from a single pore of my body surpasses what all the māras in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges possess — by that truth, by those truthful words, let all these blessings of Māra be undone. And let Māra the Evil One himself, in the form of a householder, proclaim at the crossroads and at the three-way and four-way junctions: 'Offer alms to Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma! Offer alms! To offer to him brings great fruit! Greater merit is produced by offering so much as a fingernail's tip of alms to Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, than by serving, honouring, and reverencing all sentient beings of the great trichiliocosm with every enjoyment and comfort for a hundred thousand years.'" Thus he made a declaration by the power of truth.

The moment Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, made that declaration by the power of truth, every single door opened right then and there. All the many people came forward to greet him, saying: "Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, welcome!" And Māra the Evil One himself, in the form of a householder, stood at the crossroads, at the three-way and four-way junctions, and proclaimed: "Offer alms to Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma! Offer alms! To offer to him brings great fruit!"

"Greater than if one were to serve, honor, and pay homage to all the sentient beings of the trichiliocosm with every enjoyment and comfort for a hundred thousand years — if one were to offer to Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, even a fingernail's worth of alms, that would produce a far vaster accumulation of merit." So he proclaimed.

Then Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, went on his alms round through the great city of Śrāvastī. When he had come out beyond the city, he stepped off the road, set the alms bowl down on the ground, and said to Māra the Evil One: "Evil One, take this bowl and go on ahead."

Māra the Evil One tried to lift the bowl from the ground but could not. He then said to Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma: "Mañjuśrī, I cannot lift this bowl from the ground."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Evil One, you are possessed of great miraculous powers and great might — lift this bowl from the ground by the force of your miraculous powers."

Then Māra the Evil One displayed every marvel of miraculous power he possessed, yet he could not lift that bowl even by so much as the breadth of a hair's tip. Astonished, he said to Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma: "Mañjuśrī, I myself, if I wished, could take a mountain-sized arrow in my palm and hurl it into the sky — and yet I cannot lift this tiny little bowl from the ground. How can this be?"

Mañjuśrī said: "The strength drawn from great sentient beings and great persons has been placed in this bowl. That is why you cannot lift it."

Then Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, himself picked up the bowl from the ground, handed it to Māra the Evil One, and said: "Evil One, take this bowl and go on ahead."

And so Māra the Evil One, like a student, took the bowl and walked ahead of Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma.

Then the divine son Vaśavartin, surrounded and accompanied by twenty thousand divine sons, came to where Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, was. He prostrated with his head at the feet of Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, and then said to Māra the Evil One: "Evil One, what is this — going ahead of Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, carrying his bowl like a servant?"

Māra replied: "Divine son, there is simply no competing with those who possess power."

The divine son said: "Evil One, yet you yourself are possessed of great miraculous powers and great might."

Then, through the blessing of Mañjuśrī, the prince of Dharma, Māra the Evil One said to the divine son Vaśavartin: "Divine son, know this: the power of Māra is the power of delusion. The power of a bodhisattva is the power of wisdom. The power of Māra is the power of pride. The power of a bodhisattva is the power of primordial wisdom. The power of Māra is the power born of false views. The power of a bodhisattva is the power of emptiness."

The power of Māra is the power of perversion. The power of a bodhisattva is the power of truth. The power of Māra is the power of "I" and "mine." The power of a bodhisattva is the power of great loving-kindness and great compassion. The power of Māra is the power of attachment, aversion, and delusion. The power of a bodhisattva is the power of the three gateways to liberation. The power of Māra is the power of birth, death, and arising. The power of a bodhisattva is the power of having fully attained the patience that realizes the birthlessness and non-arising of all phenomena.

When Māra the Evil One had taught this, five hundred divine sons from the retinue of the divine son Vaśavartin gave rise to the mind of unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. Two hundred bodhisattvas attained the patience that realizes the non-arising of phenomena.

The Third Fascicle.

Then Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, together with Māra the Evil One, placed his begging bowl in the cloister of the assembly and departed, and Māra neither saw nor heard him. Although the hour of midday had come, Māra did not see Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful either leaving or entering that dwelling. And so the thought arose in Māra: "Has Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful deceived the community of monks? I shall go into the presence of the Blessed One and report this matter."

Māra went to where the Blessed One was, and upon arriving he bowed his head to the Blessed One's two feet and said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, when midday arrived, Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful had not come out of that dwelling."

The Blessed One said to Māra: "Ānanda, did you not see anything in that circular cloister of the assembly?"

Māra said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, there was a single begging bowl full of food."

The Blessed One said to Māra: "Ānanda, go and strike the gong and gather the community of monks."

Māra said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, there are a great many monks in this community. How can a single bowl full of food suffice for them?"

The Blessed One declared: "Ānanda, do not be so faint of heart. Ānanda, even if all the sentient beings of the great trichiliocosm were to eat from that single bowl for a hundred thousand years, the bowl would still not be exhausted. And why? Because that bowl was blessed through the blessing of Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful, and the perfection of generosity of Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful arises from merit that is inexhaustible."

Hearing the Blessed One's words, Māra's heart was gladdened, and he struck the gong and assembled the community of monks. Then Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful, upon hearing the sound of the gong, came out from his own dwelling together with those divine sons and the bodhisattvas, went to the circular cloister, and from that bowl brought forth in abundance foods to eat and to taste and to savor, each kind kept separate as if set apart in its own vessel without being mixed together, satisfying every one of the many monks. All the many bodhisattvas too were fully satisfied, yet the food was neither exhausted nor diminished.

Then Māra the Evil One, wishing to create obstacles for Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful, came in the guise of a monk whose lower robe was poorly fastened, whose upper robe was poorly worn, whose physical bearing was unattractive, whose begging bowl was cracked and broken, whose robe was of poor quality, with a flat nose, ears that stuck out, and a lanky frame,

with teeth that were some too long, some far too long, some far too short, some far too dark, some far too white, some far too gaunt, some far too fat, some hunched, and some dwarfish. These conjured monks, forty thousand in

number, paid obeisance at the edge of youth and sat down at the edge of old age, so that any crowd of people who saw them would feel dismay. From that very begging bowl, food that had been cooked, prepared, and savored was served out in abundance to them as well, and although it was given, the begging bowl was not exhausted.

Then Māra the Evil One blessed it so that each one of those conjured monks, even after eating ten measures of the finest rice from the land of Magadha, remained unsatisfied. All those who were serving became utterly dismayed, yet they were unable to satisfy them.

Then Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful blessed it so that those monks, with begging bowls completely full in their hands, and with morsels placed in their mouths, could not swallow even a single bite, and fell to the ground with eyes rolling back, as though their throats were being squeezed.

Then Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful said this to Māra the Evil One: "Evil One, why do these monks of yours not eat the food?"

Māra replied: "Mañjuśrī, if these monks of mine were to die from it, surely you would not have served food mixed with poison?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Evil One, how could those who are without poison give poison? Those who mingle poison give poison; those who do not mingle poison do not give poison. Evil One, what is called poison is this: attachment, aversion, and delusion — and these are not found in the Dharma-Vinaya of the well-spoken teaching. What is called poison is: ignorance; craving for existence; the notion of 'I' and 'mine'; cause; view; name and form; attachment; anger; the view of self; the view of other; obscuration; arising; clinging to the aggregates; taking pride in the elements; grasping at the sense bases; attachment to sense objects; clinging to the three realms; contraction; distraction; fixation; conceit; death and transition; birth; coming; going; attachment to the body; clinging to life; taking what is pleasant to mind; dwelling in inversion; being at odds with dependent origination; the view of annihilation; the view of permanence; the view that things arise; the view that things perish; agitation; pride; thought; conceptuality; arising; bondage; the all-base; the ground of certainty; adherence; delight in the household state; taking up; casting off; fearing emptiness; perceiving the signless as an abyss; perceiving the wishless as a destroyer; perceiving the objectless as a real thing; regarding the element of definite emergence as something blameworthy; perceiving it as a river to be crossed; perceiving the qualities conducive to awakening as non-Dharma;

perceiving right view as wrong view; perceiving wrong view as right view; perceiving a spiritual friend as an evil companion; perceiving an evil companion as a spiritual friend; being at odds with the buddhas; abandoning the Dharma; showing disrespect toward the Saṅgha;

not delighting in places of solitude; pride; excessive pride; not having abandoned the pride of thinking "I am"; grasping tightly; inflaming disputes; perceiving what is true as false; perceiving what is false as true; perceiving desire as a virtue; perceiving the conditioned as true; perceiving saṃsāra as having ten kinds of benefit; perceiving nirvāṇa as having ten kinds of fear — such qualities as these are poisons, and those evils have no place in the well-spoken Dharma and Vinaya. Why is that?

The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of nectar. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of bliss. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching free of conceptual elaboration. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching that is not to be disparaged. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching free of all uprising of affliction. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of emergence. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching free of strife. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching free of quarrel. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching that causes no torment to oneself or others. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching endowed with loving-kindness. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of a home, a refuge, an island, and an ally. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of taming, of peace, of thorough peace, and of complete peace. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of purity, of thorough purity, of utter purity, and of luminosity. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of right diligence. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of non-disturbance. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of supreme taming. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of supreme purification. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching that is praised and extolled. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of peace, of thorough peace, and of definite certainty. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of liberation, of thorough liberation, and of utter liberation. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching that cuts off all adversarial challenge in a manner consonant with the Dharma. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching that vanquishes all māras. The teaching of the buddhas is a teaching of definite emergence from birth, death, and coming into being.

It teaches mindfulness through the close placements of mindfulness. It teaches right abandonment through not committing any evil. It teaches the

bases of miraculous power through lightness of body and mind. It teaches the spiritual faculties through faith going in advance. It teaches the powers through not being overcome by any affliction. It teaches the factors of awakening through thorough comprehension in harmony. It teaches the path through emergence. It teaches calm abiding through the quieting of mind. It teaches insight through the arousing of thorough liberation. It teaches truth through not deceiving. It teaches the four perfect knowledges through being consistent with the knowledge of meaning, of Dharma, of definitive expression, and of eloquence. It teaches impermanence and the complete declaration of suffering through aspiration directed at the conditioned. It teaches selflessness through the abandonment of all that is astonishing. It teaches peace through proceeding toward nirvāṇa. It teaches the perfections through going to the further shore. It teaches skillful means through genuinely gathering sentient beings. It teaches loving-kindness through a mind free of hostility. It teaches compassion through harmlessness. It teaches joy through dispelling unhappiness. It teaches equanimity through work accomplished. It teaches primordial wisdom through the absence of pride. It teaches the unceasing lineage of the Three Jewels through the arousal of the awakening mind. It teaches perfect accord with all that is blissful through the absence of renewed arising.

While this teaching was being expounded, five hundred sons of the gods who had come together with Māra the Sinful aroused the mind of unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening. They then spoke these words: "Blessed One, may we too come to accord with a teaching of the Buddha just like this one." The Blessed One smiled, and I asked him the reason for his smile. After I had asked, the Blessed One declared:

"Ānanda, do you see these monks who are emanations of Māra?" I replied to the Blessed One: "I see them, Blessed One. I see them, Sugata." The Blessed One then declared to me:

"Ānanda, in the final age, in the last five-hundred-year period, when the sacred Dharma is declining, most of the monks in my teaching will appear as follows: wearing their lower robes improperly, draping their upper robes improperly, wearing garments carelessly, having broken their bowls, lacking vigilance, behaving disagreeably, carrying a staff in hand, with flattened noses, and they will be lustful, contentious, torpid, with ill-formed flesh on their bodies, and afflicted by many kinds of disease.

"Why is this? At that time, Ānanda, most of the monks will be preoccupied with service and veneration, will be dependent on gain and honor, will be caught up in the busyness of many different activities, will have abandoned the Vinaya, will have forsaken the discipline of individual liberation, will transgress boundaries, will regard this present life as of great importance, and will not regard future lives as important. They will be such that it is not for the sake of the Dharma but for the sake of service and veneration that the lustful, the contentious, the torpid, those with ill-formed flesh, and those afflicted by many diseases will go forth and receive full ordination.

"At that time, Ānanda, this teaching of mine will be unworthy of being looked upon and unworthy of being heard. Even the gods will be displeased. The māras will be delighted, joyful, and content."

I then addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, why will Māra the Sinful and his hosts be delighted, joyful, and content?" The Blessed One declared:

"Ānanda, those foolish persons will themselves be performing the deeds of Māra, so Māra the Sinful will not need to exert himself in order to create obstacles for them. Māra the Sinful does not seek his opportunity among those who are not making effort. It is toward those monks who strive without interruption, like someone whose head and clothes are on fire, striving so that there be no more arising, that Māra seeks his opportunity.

"Therefore, Ānanda, strive, exert yourself, and make effort in order to attain what has not yet been attained, to realize what has not yet been realized, to actualize what has not yet been made manifest. Cut off the side of Māra. Make the Tathāgata's teaching blaze. Hold fast to the sacred Dharma. Worship me with the worship of the Dharma. This is my instruction to you."

When this teaching had been expounded, five thousand monks relinquished their vital formations, saying: "May we not live to witness the destruction of the Blessed One's sacred Dharma." With those words, they rose manifestly into the sky and consumed themselves with their own element of fire. A hundred thousand sons of the gods made offerings to them. Two hundred monks obtained the dust-free, stainless, purified Dharma-eye with respect to phenomena.

The two hundred monks liberated their minds from all defilements without remainder, attaining complete freedom. Thirty-two thousand bodhisattvas obtained the patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena (anutpattikadharmakṣānti).

Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), Brahmā, and the World-Protectors, together with their retinues, pressed their palms together before the Blessed One and spoke to him thus: "Blessed One, may we never witness the destruction of the Blessed One's sacred Dharma. May those in whose ears this enumeration of the Dharma has resounded never be pervaded by the stain of mental sloth. May they never fall under the power of those born of māra's deeds. We beseech the Blessed One to remain long in life and to continue to care for the world." So they spoke.

The venerable Śāriputra then said: "Whatever I have directly witnessed of the magical displays and the miracle of Dharma-teaching manifested by Mañjuśrī in his youthful form — these are of that very nature.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa said to the venerable Śāriputra: "Venerable Śāriputra, I too have directly witnessed certain miracles among the magical displays of Mañjuśrī in his youthful form. For by my own direct knowledge I have perceived this: not long after the Blessed One had fully and perfectly awakened, and not long after I myself had gone forth into homelessness, Mañjuśrī in his youthful form first came to this world-realm from the buddha-field of the Tathāgata Precious Life-Tree, in order to behold the Blessed One, to pay him homage, and to attend upon him. The Blessed One had also resolved to spend the rains retreat here in the great Jeta Grove of Prince Jeta at Śrāvastī, in the park of Anāthapiṇḍada. Mañjuśrī in his youthful form likewise resolved to remain for those three months of the rains retreat, yet we never once saw him in the presence of the Blessed One, within the Saṅgha, at the designated seats, at the restoration ceremony, or in acts of veneration.

"Then, when the three months of the rains retreat had come to an end and passed, at the time of the restoration ceremony and the invitation ceremony, Mañjuśrī in his youthful form showed his face. And I said to him: 'Mañjuśrī, where were you staying during those three months of the rains?' He replied: 'Venerable Mahākāśyapa, right here in this great city of Śrāvastī, in the inner quarters of Queen Prasenajit's palace.' At that, I thought to myself: it is not fitting that a bodhisattva such as this, who is implicated in transgressions, should hold the invitation ceremony together with the fully purified community of monks. And so I rose from the seat in the assembly hall and struck the gong to expel Mañjuśrī in his youthful form.

"At that point the Blessed One said to Mañjuśrī in his youthful form: 'Mañjuśrī, consider why the elder Mahākāśyapa struck the gong.' Mañjuśrī replied: 'Blessed One, on reflection, it seems it was for the sake of expelling me.' The Blessed One then declared: 'Mañjuśrī, conduct yourself with perfect purity so that no great lack of faith is directed toward you. Demonstrate your own domain of experience. Satisfy the great hearers.' Then Mañjuśrī in his youthful form entered into the bodhisattva meditative absorption called Perfectly Revealing All the Buddha-Fields."

The moment Mañjuśrī in his youthful form entered into that meditative absorption, it appeared to every monk like Mahākāśyapa who had attained purified qualities in buddha-fields throughout the ten directions as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River that he was striking the gong in order to expel Mañjuśrī in his youthful form.

The Blessed One then said to me: "Kāśyapa, why are you striking the gong?" I replied to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, Mañjuśrī in his youthful form spent the three months of the rains retreat dwelling among the retinue of the royal women, and now wishes to perform the invitation ceremony together with a Saṅgha of monks of perfect purity. It is in order to expel him that I struck the gong."

Then the Blessed One emitted light from his entire body and said to me: "Kāśyapa, look and see what is appearing throughout the ten directions." When I looked, I saw, in immeasurable and countless world-systems throughout the ten directions, elders like myself striking the gong to expel Mañjuśrī in his youthful form. And in all those world-systems I also saw Mañjuśrī in his youthful form seated at the feet of each of those blessed buddhas.

The Blessed One then said to me: "Great Kāśyapa, which is it — is it this Mañjuśrī in his youthful form who sits here before me, or those seated at the feet of the blessed buddhas in the countless and immeasurable world-systems throughout the ten directions, that you wish to expel?" At that moment, out of shame, I thought to throw the gong to the ground, but even that I was unable to do, and an unceasing sound arose from it. Just as it was in the Jeta Grove here, so too in every buddha-field without exception, without addition, without increase, it appeared to be doing the same.

I then bowed at the two feet of the Blessed One and said to him: "Blessed One, I am possessed of a one-sided understanding, and not having sought out the

domain of activity of bodhisattvas with its boundless scope, I struck the gong. I ask forgiveness of Mañjuśrī in his youthful form."

The Blessed One said to me: "Great Kāśyapa, in all those buddha-fields where you saw this Mañjuśrī in his youthful form — in each and every one he was dwelling for three months of the rains retreat in a householder's home in order to bring sentient beings to full ripening. Great Kāśyapa, even though Mañjuśrī in his youthful form had vowed to spend the rains retreat here in this great city of Śrāvastī among the retinue of the royal women, he nonetheless brought five hundred women from the retinue of King Prasenajit to full and irreversible ripening toward unsurpassed and perfect awakening. He also established five hundred men, five hundred young boys, five hundred young girls, and five hundred courtesans in irreversibility from unsurpassed and perfect awakening. And he caused many other sentient beings to be established in the vehicle of the hearers and to proceed to the higher realms."

I then said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what kind of Dharma did Mañjuśrī in his youthful form teach, that he was able to bring that many sentient beings to full ripening?"

The Blessed One replied: "Great Kāśyapa, you yourself should ask Mañjuśrī in his youthful form what kind of Dharma he taught to bring that many sentient beings to full ripening, and he himself will give you the answer."

I then said this to Mañjuśrī in his youthful form: "Mañjuśrī, what kind of Dharma did you teach that brought that many sentient beings to full ripening?"

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, beings such as those are not brought to full ripening through the teaching of Dharma. Why is that? Venerable Mahākāśyapa, there are sentient beings who are brought to full ripening through playful amusement, through being seized and disciplined, through lavish giving, through impoverishment and destitution, through grand display, through the miracle of proclaiming, through the miracle of instruction, through the miracle of magical power, through the form of Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), through the form of Brahmā, through the form of a world-guardian, through the form of a wheel-turning king, through the body of a buddha, through the form of a pratyekabuddha, through the form of a śrāvaka, through intimidation with fear, through harsh words, through gentle words, and through bringing benefit. Why is that? Venerable Mahākāśyapa, the conduct of sentient beings is varied, and it is precisely through a variety of actions that they are brought to full ripening. Venerable Mahākāśyapa, those

sentient beings who have thus been brought to ripening will afterwards, through the teaching of Dharma, become thoroughly tamed."

Then I said to him: "Mañjuśrī, how great a number of sentient beings — according to their disposition — did you bring to full ripening through this conduct?"

He replied: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, as many as the dharmadhātu."

I said: "Mañjuśrī, and how great is the dharmadhātu?"

He said: "As vast as the element of space."

I said: "And how vast is the element of space?"

He said: "As great as the realm of sentient beings. Venerable Mahākāśyapa, in this way the dharmadhātu, the element of space, and the realm of sentient beings are non-dual and indivisible."

Then I said: "Mañjuśrī, if in this way not a single sentient being ever fully passes beyond sorrow into nirvāṇa, would the arising of buddhas not be purposeless?"

He replied: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, consider this: a certain person has been struck by a bilious fever and begins to vomit in various ways. Some people think, 'This person has been seized by a spirit.' Then a skilled physician arrives and, by means of treatments such as the application of ghee and the like, pacifies that bilious fever, after which the person ceases to vomit in those various ways. Venerable Mahākāśyapa, what do you think — did a god, a nāga, or a yakṣa then emerge from him?"

I replied: "Mañjuśrī, no — it was simply that through treatments such as the application of ghee, that bile was pacified."

Mañjuśrī said: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, did that physician not render great benefit to that person?"

I replied to him: "Mañjuśrī, it is exactly as you have said."

He continued: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, in just the same way, those who dwell in the world have been struck by the fever of inverted views — perceiving a self where there is no self, and clinging to selfhood where selfhood does not exist — and so they revolve in saṃsāra. The blessed buddhas, the Blessed Ones, possessed of great compassion, arise in the world and, through various similes, examples, and various gateways for entering the Dharma, teach the Dharma to those sentient beings — so that those who

perceive a self may come to fully know that perception, and so that they may abandon their inverted views. Having heard the Dharma, those beings become free from all such perceptions, and they no longer grasp outwardly or cling to anything further. Having abandoned the perception of self, they cross over the river. And having crossed over, they go beyond, they are perfected —

they are counted among those who have passed beyond sorrow — they have entered nirvāṇa.

Venerable Mahākāśyapa then said: "Mañjuśrī, what do you think? Is there any self, any sentient being, any life-force, any one born, any person whatsoever, who has passed beyond sorrow and attained nirvāṇa?"

I replied to him: "Mañjuśrī, there is not. Yet by genuinely teaching equality, inverted views are abandoned."

Mañjuśrī then said: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, it is precisely for this reason that buddhas arise in the world — that is to say, in order to genuinely teach equality. It is not for the sake of arising, nor for the sake of cessation, but solely in order to realize the absence of all affliction."

I then said to him the following: "Mañjuśrī, bodhisattvas who conceptualize even a dharmadhātu possessed of such an intrinsic nature, while still not casting aside the armor they have donned for the sake of bringing all sentient beings to full maturation and without becoming discouraged — for such beings, who have put on armor on behalf of those sentient beings who by nature have passed beyond sorrow, this is not a difficult thing to do."

He replied: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, in that way, a bodhisattva, a great being, has indeed put on the great armor."

I then said to him: "Mañjuśrī, you should have the confidence to describe the bodhisattva's armor."

Mañjuśrī then said: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, the great armor of a bodhisattva has thirty-two pieces. Bodhisattvas who have put on these pieces of armor carry out the conduct of bodhisattvas. What are those thirty-two?"

Venerable Mahākāśyapa, taking hold of immeasurable saṃsāra through the characteristic of the dream-like intrinsic nature — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Bringing immeasurable sentient beings to full maturation through the characteristic of no-self — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Honoring and serving immeasurable buddhas through the characteristic of the dharmakāya — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Hearing and holding all that the buddhas have taught through the characteristic of being equal to an echo — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Guarding all buddha-qualities by the characteristic of perfectly gathering them into the dharmadhātu — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Subduing all māras through the characteristic of all afflictions being naturally and thoroughly purified — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Thoroughly cutting through all the arguments of opponents by means of Dharma, through the characteristic of entering dependent origination — which dispels both existence and non-existence — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Relinquishing all one's possessions through the characteristic of abandoning all aggregates — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Perfectly taking up all implements of moral discipline, training, and the qualities born of cultivation through the characteristic of having nothing to be produced — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Patience, gentleness, and contentment through the characteristic of being free from anger — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Diligence that neither grasps nor discards, through the characteristic of seclusion of body and mind — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

All meditative concentration (dhyāna), all liberations, all meditative absorptions (samādhi), and all states of meditative attainment, through the characteristic of being free from all support — these are pieces of the bodhisattva's armor.

The Perfection of Wisdom that is unobstructed, through the characteristic of completely purifying the view of ignorance and bewilderment — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Great skillful means, through the characteristic of pointing out all actions — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Great loving-kindness, through the characteristic of being free from hostility — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor."

Great compassion, through the characteristic of being equal to the five fingers of space — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Great joy, through the characteristic of being utterly without weariness — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Great equanimity, through the characteristic of making no distinction between pleasure and suffering — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Through the characteristic of not grasping at liberation even when it has arrived in the palm of one's hand, along with the characteristic of completely fulfilling all intentions — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Not falling into fault through the characteristic of blamelessness, in the form of not taking anything to mind — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Thoroughly understanding phenomena as being like illusions, guarding against the five aggregates as though they were executioners — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Through the very equality of the dharmadhātu, regarding the four elements as one would a venomous serpent — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Through the characteristic of being unattached to all objects, perceiving the six sense bases as though they were an empty village — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Through the characteristic of having no all-base consciousness, being unmixed with the three realms — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Through the characteristic of clearing away existence, deliberately taking up existence — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Great heroism, through the characteristic of irreversibility — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

The great physician, through the characteristic of administering the medicine of Dharma to all sentient beings, each according to what is appropriate — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

The great caravan leader, through the characteristic of showing the path of the three vehicles — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Through the characteristic of knowing what has been done for all buddhas and repaying what has been done, not cutting off the lineage of the Three Jewels — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Having attained patient acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena, the characteristic that all phenomena are by nature without arising — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Through the characteristic of transcending the grounds of all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, attaining the ground of irreversibility — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Through the characteristic of realizing all the qualities of a buddha exactly as they are by means of a wisdom endowed with a single moment of mind, adorning the seat of awakening — this is a piece of the bodhisattva's armor.

Venerable Mahākāśyapa, these thirty-two pieces of the bodhisattva's great armor are as follows: even if those pieces of armor were to be divided, the four great elements might be changed into something else, yet there is no fear that a bodhisattva would turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Thereupon I spoke these words. "Mañjuśrī, not a single one of those pieces of armor belongs to śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas."

He replied: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, therefore śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas are said not to have donned the great armor."

"Venerable Mahākāśyapa, what do you think? Is the armor that is to be donned by a master of archery possessed of great power something that ordinary people can put on?" I replied to him thus: "Mañjuśrī, that is not so — ordinary people are incapable of donning that armor."

He said: "Venerable Mahākāśyapa, in just the same way, the armor that is to be donned by a bodhisattva is not worn by any śrāvaka or pratyekabuddha."

When this account of the bodhisattva's armor was given, twenty thousand sons of the gods gave rise to the mind directed toward unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

The Venerable Śāriputra, at the miraculous transformations displayed by the youthful Mañjuśrī,

those miraculous displays of Dharma-teaching that I myself perceived directly were such as these.

Then the Venerable Gāṃgāputra addressed the Venerable Śāriputra with these words: "Venerable Śāriputra, I myself directly witnessed certain of the miraculous transformations of the youthful Mañjuśrī. Venerable Śāriputra,

through my supernormal knowledge I once perceived that the Blessed One was dwelling together with a great Saṅgha of some five hundred monks in the multi-storied mansion in the great grove of the city of Vaiśālī. At that time, Venerable Śāradvatīputra, a naked ascetic named Truthful Son of the Naked Ones was sitting in Vaiśālī, surrounded by six hundred naked ascetics, facing outward, being attended upon, honored, revered, worshipped, and venerated. I entered into meditative absorption and looked upon the roots of virtue of those other non-Buddhist adherents. I saw there many hundreds of sentient beings, non-Buddhist adherents who were fit to be tamed, and so I went to them and taught them the Dharma. They would not attend to my Dharma teaching, would not lend an ear and listen. Remaining unmoved even by the wish to understand, they went so far as to slander and mock me, and also uttered harsh words against me. For three months I was unable to bring even one of those sentient beings to full maturation, and so I became disheartened. Having grown disheartened, I returned.

"Thereupon the youthful Mañjuśrī conjured five hundred non-Buddhists, appointed himself as their teacher, went with a retinue of five hundred to the place where Truthful Son of the Naked Ones was staying, and upon arriving, prostrated with his head at the feet of Truthful Son of the Naked Ones, sat before him, and addressed him with these words: 'We have heard from another region the great renown and the vast verses of this noble one, and have come here to the city of Vaiśālī. You are our Teacher; we are your disciples; we receive instruction from you. Please arrange matters for us so that we shall not see that ascetic (śramaṇa) Gautama, nor hear from him Dharma teachings contrary to ours.'

"Truthful Son of the Naked Ones replied: 'Excellent! Excellent, O noble men! You who are endowed with faith and endowed with clarity — before long you will come to know this teaching of mine.' Then Truthful Son of the Naked Ones said to his own retinue: 'Come here — dwell together with these five hundred sons of the brahmins in mutual delight and harmony, examining and analyzing the Dharma together. Whatever little these ones say today, you should take it very carefully to heart.'

"Then the youthful Mañjuśrī, together with the five hundred conjured naked-ascetic followers and the disciples of the other non-Buddhists, sat down. He displayed to himself and to his retinue an even more extensive and unceasing stream of ascetic practices, vows, conduct, and words of training than theirs. At times he would recite praises of the Three Jewels; at other times

he would recite praises of the genuine virtues of Truthful Son of the Naked Ones. Having gained their trust in this way, at a different time and occasion the youthful Mañjuśrī addressed an assembly of other non-Buddhists with these words: 'Venerable ones, our treatises, our mantras, our Vedas, and our'

there are also praises of the genuine virtues of the ascetic Gautama, just as they arise in our treatises. And why is that? It is because the ascetic Gautama was perfectly endowed with lineage, being born of both a noble father and a noble mother, born into the lineage of wheel-turning kings (cakravartins), and bearing the marks of one possessed of a hundredfold merit. At the very moment of his birth, Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) and Brahmā received him, and the great thousand-fold triple world system shook in six ways. Without being held, he took seven steps, and he spoke these words: "I am the foremost of the world; birth and death shall be brought to an end." Two streams of water then flowed forth, and Śakra, Brahmā, and the world-protectors bathed him. Even without being struck, the sounds of divine and human music arose. He then emitted a light by which all the lower realms were individually liberated and all the abodes of Māra were overcome. All those whose faculties had been impaired had their faculties restored. In that very instant, all the afflictions of all sentient beings were pacified, and they attained supreme bliss. The brahmins skilled in Vedic ritual also proclaimed: "If he remains in the household, he will become a wheel-turning king; if he goes to the forest, he will become a buddha, a Dharma-king." He then renounced his status as a wheel-turning king and went forth. At the Seat of Awakening (Vajrāsana) he subdued a hundred trillion hosts of Māra and attained awakening. He then turned the wheel of Dharma — a wheel that no ascetic, brahmin, god, Māra, Brahmā, or anyone else in the world is able to turn in a manner consistent with the Dharma. He also taught the Dharma: the holy life, good in the beginning, good in the middle, and good in the end, excellent in meaning, excellent in words, unmixed, complete, pure, and thoroughly refined — and he taught it fully and genuinely. Concerning this, the good in the beginning for his śrāvakas is as follows: good conduct of body, good conduct of speech, and good conduct of mind. The good in the middle is training in the higher moral discipline, the higher mind, and the higher wisdom. The good in the end is the three gateways to liberation: emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness. Furthermore, the good in the beginning is aspiration, diligence, and heedfulness. The good in the middle is mindfulness, meditative absorption, and one-pointedness of mind. The good in the end is wisdom, special insight,

and primordial wisdom. Furthermore, the good in the beginning is unwavering faith in the Buddha. The good in the middle is unwavering faith in the Dharma. The good in the end is attaining the fruit through unwavering faith in the Saṅgha. Furthermore, the good in the beginning is listening to others. The good in the middle is proper mental engagement. The good in the end is the noble right view. Furthermore, the good in the beginning is the thorough understanding of suffering and the abandonment of its origin. The good in the middle is cultivating the path. The good in the end is realizing cessation directly. These, then, are the good in the beginning, the good in the middle, and the good in the end for the śrāvakas.

Now, what are the good in the beginning, the good in the middle, and the good in the end for bodhisattvas? The good in the beginning is not abandoning the awakening mind (bodhicitta). The good in the middle is not desiring the Lesser Vehicle. The good in the end is dedicating everything entirely to omniscience. Furthermore, the good in the beginning is great loving-kindness, embracing all sentient beings with equanimity of mind. The good in the middle is great compassion, thinking continually of whatever needs to be done for all sentient beings. The good in the end is reflecting with certainty through the minds of joy and equanimity. Furthermore, the good in the beginning is cutting off the mind of miserliness,

The good in the beginning is abandoning corrupt moral discipline, dispelling harmful intentions, abandoning laziness, not engaging in all forms of distraction, and abandoning corrupt wisdom. The good in the middle is fully completing the accumulations of generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, and wisdom. The good in the end is fully completing the six perfections and dedicating everything entirely to omniscience.

Furthermore, the good in the beginning is ripening sentient beings to full maturity through the four means of gathering. The good in the middle is upholding the sacred Dharma without regard for body or life. The good in the end is protecting oneself blamelessly from the fear of transgression.

Furthermore, the good in the beginning is the conduct of a bodhisattva, which consists in not abandoning a mind equal to the earth. The good in the middle is the ground of non-return, known through the understanding of what to enter and what to turn away from. The good in the end is obtaining mastery and being bound by just one more birth. These, then, are the good in the

beginning, the good in the middle, and the good in the end for bodhisattvas.

While Mañjuśrī in his youthful form was teaching the Dharma in this way, one after another, to that assembly of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), five hundred of those non-Buddhists obtained the eye of Dharma, pure and stainless, free from all dust. Eight thousand other non-Buddhists gave rise to the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Then those five hundred emanations touched their five limbs to the ground, made prostration, and also uttered the words: "Homage to the Buddha! Homage to the Buddha!" Following their example, all those in the assembly of non-Buddhists likewise touched their five limbs to the ground, made prostration, and also uttered the words: "Homage to the Buddha! Homage to the Buddha!" And Śakra, lord of the gods, gave them māṇḍārava flowers, saying: "With these, make offerings to the Blessed One."

The fourth and final section. Then Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, surrounded by a great retinue and with them arrayed before him, came directly to the walk of the bamboo grove and arrived where the Blessed One was. He bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat to one side. That assembly of non-Buddhists also made offerings to the Blessed One with those māṇḍārava flowers, then circumambulated the Blessed One three times and stood to one side.

Then, through the blessing of Mañjuśrī in his youthful form, those five hundred emanations addressed the Blessed One thus:

Blessed One, the Tathāgata is the dharmakāya; we do not seek to behold the Buddha as though he were a visible form. Blessed One, the Dharma is inexpressible; we do not seek to listen to the Blessed One's Dharma as though it were something to be heard. Blessed One, the Saṅgha of the Blessed One's śrāvakas is distinguished by the unconditioned; we do not seek to pay homage to the Saṅgha as a conventional object of service. Blessed One, the dharmadhātu is without qualities or benefits to be obtained; we do not seek qualities. Blessed One, all phenomena have utterly not arisen; we do not seek arising. Blessed One, liberation is without leaves, without flowers, and without fruits; we do not seek to attain it. Blessed One, full knowledge is free from duality; we do not seek to fully examine suffering. Blessed One, all phenomena have utterly not arisen; we do not seek to abandon the origin of suffering.

Blessed One, all phenomena are utterly ceased; we do not seek to actualize cessation. Blessed One, the path is free from existence and non-existence; we

do not seek to cultivate the path. Blessed One, all phenomena, when abiding, do not truly abide; we do not seek to establish mindfulness. Blessed One, liberation is free from meritorious formations, demeritorious formations, and immovable formations; we do not seek to practice the four right abandonments. Blessed One, there is no coming from anywhere and no going anywhere — this we take as our measure; we do not seek the bases of miraculous power. Blessed One, the object is free from sense faculties; we do not seek the sense faculties. Blessed One, all phenomena are without power and are feeble; we do not seek power. Blessed One, in the ultimate sense there is nothing whatsoever that is awakened to; we do not seek the limbs of awakening. Blessed One, no being travels to the end of the world; we do not seek the path. Blessed One, in the peaceful expanse there is no distraction; we do not seek calm abiding. Blessed One, by the wisdom that transcends the world not even the slightest thing is seen; we do not seek special insight. Blessed One, thus there is utterly nothing to adopt or reject; we do not seek exertion. Blessed One, the dharmadhātu is not properly awakened to; we do not seek liberation. Blessed One, the śramaṇa (Skt. śramaṇa) is free from all attachment; we do not seek the state of the śramaṇa. Blessed One, the brahmin (Skt. brāhmaṇa) is free from all evil; we do not seek the state of the brahmin. Blessed One, the intrinsic nature of the Dharma is undifferentiated; we do not seek the status of a fully ordained monk. Blessed One, the six sense bases are themselves ceased; we do not seek to go to the other shore. Blessed One, thus not even the slightest thing is found to be destroyed; we are not those of few desires. Blessed One, thus not a single phenomenon is sought; we are not those who know contentment. Blessed One, thus we make no declaration with body or mind; we are not those who dwell in seclusion. Blessed One, thus there is no abiding in the three realms; we are not without defilement. Blessed One, thus the two are not properly seen at all; we are not unmixed. Blessed One, thus all three realms are the wilderness of the yogin; we do not seek the wilderness. Blessed One, thus because there is no antidote, there is no conflict; we are not those who abide without mental afflictions. Blessed One, thus having abandoned the perception of alms-seeking, we are not alms-gatherers. Blessed One, thus saṃsāra itself is not properly seen to exist at all; we are not afraid of saṃsāra. Blessed One, thus we do not think, we do not conceptualize; we do not abandon attachment, aversion, and delusion. Blessed One, thus the intrinsic nature of phenomena is without affliction; we do not strive to abandon the afflictions. Blessed One, thus one's own body is not truly a body; we remain unperturbed by our own body.

Blessed One, thus suchness has the defining mark of being immovable; we do not maintain what has been fashioned by views.

Blessed One, thus liberation itself has the essential nature of permanence, bliss, self, and purity; we do not strive to abandon inverted views. Blessed One, thus the far shore is not seen from this shore; we do not strive to cross over the river. Blessed One, thus liberation is without obscuration and without conceptual examination; we do not strive to abandon the obscurations. Blessed One, thus the ultimate limit is without agitation; we do not strive to suppress agitation. Blessed One, thus the contemplative life is without wrongdoing; we do not strive to dispel remorse. Blessed One, thus from the very beginning there is aspiration and faith; we do not strive to remove doubt. Blessed One, thus through aspiration liberation is realized; we do not strive to dispel torpor. Blessed One, thus all phenomena are utterly and completely nirvāṇa; we do not seek nirvāṇa as a goal to be attained.

When this teaching was spoken, two hundred monks, without any further clinging, were liberated in mind from all defilements. Two hundred monks who had attained the four meditative concentrations but were in the final existence, yet harbored the conceit of having attained what they had not attained, rose from their seats and said: "How strange! These ones teach the Dharma in contradiction to the entire world. Formerly, when we heard Dharma taught in accordance with convention, but now they are teaching what is not Dharma, not Vinaya, not the teaching of the Teacher." With these words they departed.

The venerable Śāriputra then said to the young Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, these two hundred monks rose from their seats and, with these words — that this teaching of the Dharma contradicts the entire world — they have departed."

Mañjuśrī replied: "Venerable Śāriputra, there is a range of reasons why this teaching of the Dharma is in contradiction to the entire world. Why is that? Venerable Śāriputra, the world is attached to the aggregates, the elements, and the sense bases; it seeks nirvāṇa by abandoning saṃsāra, yet does not understand that saṃsāra, being inherently unapprehensible, is itself nirvāṇa. Here, there is nothing that is saṃsāra and nothing that is nirvāṇa; the forbearance that accords with this is without contradiction. Clinging to the presentation of the Four Noble Truths — that itself is the ground of contradiction. In ultimate truth, there is not even a presentation of the Four Noble Truths; that is without contradiction. Harmonizing with the cause of the

path and attaining the fruit — these two are dual; what is dual is contradictory. The equanimity of the path whereby all phenomena are equal — this is non-dual; and what is non-dual is without contradiction. As long as one strives in the grasping of 'I' and 'mine,' there is manifest conceit. As long as there is manifest conceit, there is contradiction. One who does not sever, does not exalt, does not make equal with equality, does not make unequal with inequality, who is not one who acts, not one who elaborates — such a one is without manifest conceit; and one who is without elevated conceit is without contradiction. What is without contradiction is non-dual. With this in mind, the Blessed One himself declared: 'I do not dispute with the world; it is the world that disputes with me.' Why is that? Because the Tathāgata has cut the root of disputation. What then is that root of disputation which the Tathāgata has cut?

It is this: "This is true; this is false." Regarding that, the Blessed One himself declared: "Brahmin, what is the word called 'true,' and why is 'false' also spoken? For one in whom there is neither sameness nor difference, who could engage in disputation?"

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful, blessed all the roads by which those monks had gone, filling them entirely with fire. Wherever those monks went, they saw every direction filled with fire, and they were unable to pass beyond that mass of flames. Those who had gone up into the sky through the power of supernormal ability saw the entire expanse of the sky covered by an iron net. When they looked downward, they saw a great mass of water. Disoriented and with their hair standing on end, they looked back toward the road of the Jeta Grove and saw it covered with blue lotuses, red lotuses, white water-lilies, and white lotuses, and they saw many crowds of people coming along that road to hear the Dharma from the Blessed One. Seeing this, those monks too turned back. Making their way toward the Jeta Grove of Anāthapiṇḍada, they went toward the hall of the bamboo grove surrounding it, and toward the Blessed One. Having arrived, they bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times, and took their seats to one side.

When they had taken their seats to one side, I said to them: "Venerable ones, where did you go, and from where have you come?"

They said: "Venerable Gampopa, we are arhats, whose defilements are exhausted, who have attained meditative concentration, who have gone beyond the basis of supernormal powers. When we heard Mañjuśrī the youthful teaching Dharma that was discordant, we rose from our seats and

departed — and we saw this entire buddha-field filled with fire, and were unable to pass beyond that mass of flames."

I asked the Blessed One: "What is the ground of the arhat whose defilements are exhausted?"

The Blessed One declared to me: "Gampopa, for one who is engaged in the fire of attachment, aversion, and delusion, to pass beyond a mass of fire is simply not possible. For one obscured by the net of views, to cut through an iron net is not possible. For one who has entered the river of craving, to cross beyond a mass of water is not possible. Why is that? Gampopa, these monks are engaged in the fire of attachment, aversion, and delusion, and thus they are unable to pass beyond the great mass of fire. They are obscured by the net of views, and thus unable to cut through the iron net. They have entered the stream of craving, and thus unable to cross beyond the mass of water. Gampopa, consider this: the phenomena that constitute this mass of fire, this iron net, and this mass of water — they come from nowhere and go nowhere; they appear only through the blessing of Mañjuśrī the youthful. Likewise, Gampopa, the phenomena that constitute attachment, aversion, and delusion, what has been made into views, and the craving for existence — these too come from nowhere and go nowhere; they appear only as conceptualization, discursive thought, and thorough mental elaboration led on by inverted cognition, without an owner, without a self, without anything to be grasped — as an overlay attributed to self and other. In this, the yogin brings a distracted mind to one-pointedness through the practice of yoga."

By bringing the mind to one-pointedness, the yogin accomplishes calm abiding. Through the accumulation of calm abiding, meditative concentration arises. Yet even upon attaining meditative concentration, one does not make it a cause for conceit, nor does one cling to it with attachment. With a mind made serviceable through meditative concentration, one examines phenomena — investigating what serves as the cause and what serves as the condition for any given phenomenon — and in that investigation one discerns them exactly as they are, in full accord with reality. It is as follows: conditioned by ignorance, formations arise; conditioned by formations, consciousness; conditioned by consciousness, name-and-form; conditioned by name-and-form, the six sense sources; conditioned by the six sense sources, contact; conditioned by contact, feeling; conditioned by feeling, craving; conditioned by craving, grasping; conditioned by grasping, becoming; conditioned by becoming, birth; conditioned by birth, aging and death, sorrow,

lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and turmoil arise. Thus it is that this entire great mass of suffering comes to be. This is called the path of formations constructed through inversion.

When ignorance ceases, formations cease. When formations cease, consciousness ceases. When consciousness ceases, name-and-form cease. When name-and-form cease, the six sense sources cease. When the six sense sources cease, contact ceases. When contact ceases, feeling ceases. When feeling ceases, craving ceases. When craving ceases, grasping ceases. When grasping ceases, becoming ceases. When becoming ceases, birth ceases. When birth ceases, aging and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, mental distress, and turmoil all cease. Thus it is that this entire great mass of suffering ceases. This is what is called genuine accomplishment — a definitive entry into the unconditioned.

Now, the cessation of ignorance is not something past, not something future, not something presently arisen. Nevertheless, because there occurs a mental engagement that is not in accord with reality, ignorance arises. When one engages mentally in accord with reality — examining with discernment — that arising does not occur. That non-arising is the thorough cessation; therefore it is called the cessation of ignorance.

In this context, mental engagement in accord with reality means discerning this body — arisen from the four great elements — in the following way: this body is inert matter, appearing as grass, as wood, as a wall, as stone. And as for what is called mind, or mentation, or consciousness — that too is without form, cannot be pointed out, without obstruction, without manifest apprehension, like an illusion, like a dream; it is not to be found within, without, or in between. Thus, the monk who strives in mental engagement in accord with reality will come to understand that all phenomena are unborn by their intrinsic nature. And that which is unborn is the ultimate.

When this teaching was being taught, those two hundred monks freed their minds from the defilements without residue of clinging.

Then the son of the Nirgrantha woman, Satyadeva, scattered his retinue and, accompanied by five hundred attendants, went to where the Prince's grove stood — the Jeta Grove (Jetavana), the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, the benefactor of the helpless — and to where the cloister of the garden of the bamboo grove stood, and he approached the Blessed One. Rejoicing together with the Blessed One, exchanging various words of mutual delight and

gladness, he then addressed the Blessed One in these words:

"O Gautama, O ascetic Gautama — I have repeatedly heard it said that Gautama leads away the retinues of others through the art of enticement. Now I have witnessed this directly with my own eyes."

For in this way Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful, had opened up his retinue and presented them to the ascetic Gautama. And the ascetic Gautama had taken hold of them with a wrong kind of grasping, so that they would no longer come to his side, would no longer pay him honor, would no longer lend him an ear and listen, would no longer settle their minds in the intention to know everything through him.

At that time there was present in that assembly a wandering mendicant named Victorious Intellect, a kinsman of the wanderer called Moonbeam. He addressed the naked ascetic Truthful One in these words:

"O Truthful One, son of the naked ascetics — do not lose faith in the Blessed One, in the śrāvakas of the Blessed One, or in Mañjuśrī, the ever-youthful. For a long time you have had no benefit, no good, only suffering and downfall. I will venture to offer you this illustration of the naked ascetics. Consider a certain man, childish by nature, deficient in wisdom, who desires cream and goes seeking butter, yet pours milk into a water jar and churns it. However much he churns, vain and fruitless as his efforts are, he will never by that method obtain butter or cream. Just so, all the marvellous practices outside this teaching — the yoga, the meditation, the austerities, the vows and observances of all kinds — these are wrongly grasped, and I say they are like churning a jar of water. Moreover, by turning a hostile mind against the Dharma and Vinaya proclaimed by the Tathāgata, one will fall into the abyss of hell.

"Now consider this further illustration of the naked ascetics. A certain man, wise by nature and endowed with discernment, desires cream and goes seeking butter, yet he pours milk into a milk jar and churns it. With little effort he will draw out butter from the buttermilk — from the butter, pure cream. Just so, whether one remains a householder or has gone forth into the homeless life, if one applies oneself to the Dharma and Vinaya proclaimed by the Tathāgata with faith and with abundant devotion, striving, working, and making effort, then just as one obtains cream from the jar of milk one was seeking, so too will those persons swiftly attain the noble liberation.

"Consider yet another illustration. Suppose a certain man were to set out a hundred thousand vessels made of clay by another man, and were then to give that same number of vessels made of precious jewels — O naked ascetic, what do you think? Has that man deceived the other man?" He answered: "Victorious Intellect, he has not." He replied: "Just so, O naked ascetic — the śrāvakas of the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), who are like vessels of clay, are broken, and those who are made into vessels of the precious Dharma in the teaching of the Tathāgata — by this no deception whatsoever is done to the non-Buddhists.

"Consider another illustration. A caravan leader who is unskilled in means, puffed up with conceit, leads many in a caravan onto a bad road. But another caravan leader who is skilled in means, who knows the road and sees the road, turns them back from that bad road and leads them onto the right road. Just so, O naked ascetic, all six of your teachers are those who do not know the road, who are unskilled in the road, and they have led you, the many sentient beings, onto a bad road. The Tathāgata, however, knows the road and is skilled in the road; he turns those sentient beings back from that bad road and leads them onto the right road.

"O naked ascetic, that being so, take these your followers and go."

And so the naked ascetic Truthful One departed together with the twenty-two thousand naked ascetics.

The remainder, having attained direct knowledge, were ordained by the Blessed One with the words, "Come, monks."

Then the Blessed One spoke thus to the wandering monk Victorious Wisdom: "Victorious Wisdom, did you see those twenty-two thousand naked ascetics who departed together with the naked ascetic Truthful One?"

He replied, "Blessed One, I did see them."

The Blessed One declared, "Victorious Wisdom, all of those will be counted among the first assembly of the Tathāgata Maitreya. Why is that? Because they heard this profound Dharma taught in that way. As for the naked ascetic Truthful One himself: just as my monk Śāriputra is now, so too shall he become, within the teaching of the Tathāgata Maitreya, the foremost among śrāvakas in greatness of wisdom. Why is that? Because he has devotion toward me, yet due to excessive pride he does not fully relinquish his views."

Then the wandering monk Victorious Wisdom said this to the youthful Mañjuśrī: "Mañjuśrī, in the last age, at the final period of the last five hundred years, how many monks possessed of manifest pride will there be?"

Mañjuśrī replied, "Noble son, in the last age, at the final period of the last five hundred years, monks possessed of manifest pride will be rare. Why is that, noble son? One cannot fall into manifest pride without having cultivated the four meditative concentrations. Why is that? At that time, even monks who achieve mental stillness will be rare — let alone those who enter into meditative absorption in the four concentrations. Therefore, noble son, in the last age, at the final period of the last five hundred years, monks possessed of manifest pride will be rare.

"Noble son, however, there are two who are possessed of manifest pride. Which two? One who, through attachment to views, has manifest pride regarding meditative concentration; and one who, for the sake of gain and honor, falls into manifest pride merely by claiming the noble lineage, ethical discipline, learning, cultivation, and qualities of equipment. These two are possessed of manifest pride. And whoever is possessed of manifest pride and abandons the Dharma and Vinaya taught by the Tathāgata — those will go to the hells, to animal rebirths, and to the realm of Yama.

"It was asked: Mañjuśrī, without knowing another's mind, how can one recognize that this person is possessed of manifest pride?

"It was said: If, upon hearing the words 'ordinary beings will pass beyond sorrow, but arhats will not,' one becomes frightened, know that person to be possessed of manifest pride. If, upon hearing the words 'ordinary beings will see the Tathāgata, but arhats will not,' one becomes frightened, know that person to be possessed of manifest pride. If, upon hearing the words 'ordinary beings will perfect generosity, but arhats will not,' one becomes frightened, know that person to be possessed of manifest pride. If, upon hearing the words 'ordinary beings will bring joy to the Tathāgata, but arhats will not,' one becomes frightened, know that person to be possessed of manifest pride.

"Those who are unmoved by all mental afflictions are independent. Those who are independent are proper recipients of offerings in the world. Those who are moved by afflictions are dependent. Those who are dependent are not proper recipients of offerings in the world. And those who quarrel over this — know them to be possessed of manifest pride."

Those who do not understand this mode of the profound Dharma — that all phenomena arise — know them to be possessed of manifest pride. Those who do not enter into this mode of truth — that all phenomena are not to be fully known, not to be abandoned, not to be cultivated, and not to be directly realized — know them to be possessed of manifest pride.

It was asked: "Mañjuśrī, what is the seal of one who is without manifest pride?"

It was said: "Freedom from contradiction and freedom from quarrel — that is the absence of manifest pride. Consider this, son of good family: just as the lion, king of beasts, is not frightened by any sound, so too, son of good family, a monk without manifest pride is not frightened by any sound. Why is that? Because he understands all phenomena to be like an echo. An echo has no mind, no mentation, no consciousness, yet sound arises in dependence upon it. In the same way, he truly understands mind and mentation as they are. Knowing that all sounds depend upon conditions, he generates no delight in any sound whatsoever. He does not become attached to the sound of the Buddha, nor does he become angry at the sound of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas). He does not become attached to the sound of purification, nor does he become angry at the sound of affliction. And having understood the prior limit and the subsequent limit of all sounds, this, son of good family, is called the seal of one without manifest pride — the seal of neither placing nor imputing, the seal of things as they truly are, the seal of perfect establishment, the seal of the defining mark of intrinsic nature, the seal of entering into a single mode, the seal of perfect convergence in the dharmadhātu, the seal of the undifferentiated nature of suchness, the seal of the abode of the ultimate limit, the seal of ultimate emptiness, the seal of the equality of the three times, the seal of primordial non-arising, and the seal of individually discerning intrinsic nature. Son of good family, when a monk without manifest pride hears all Dharma sealed with those seals, he will not become confused, he will not become doubtful, and he will come to understand that no self is to be apprehended."

Then the wanderer Jinabuddhi addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I previously heard some praise of the qualities of this Great Vehicle spoken by the wanderer Upācāra and the wanderer Candrasambandha. Blessed One, having now heard the holy Dharma taught by Mañjuśrī the youthful, I have generated the mind of unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening (bodhicitta). Blessed One, please teach the Dharma now so that I may by all means accumulate the dharmas conducive to

awakening and, having swiftly and fully awakened to unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening, may bring benefit to sentient beings beyond measure and beyond count."

The Blessed One declared: "Jinabuddhi, these two dharmas of bodhisattvas swiftly lead to the realization of unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening. What are the two? They are diligence and heedfulness. What is diligence? It is the complete relinquishment of all wealth and possessions acquired through Dharma. What is heedfulness? It is the complete dedication to awakening without placing hope in karmic maturation."

In that context, diligence is the earnest striving to abandon all non-virtuous phenomena and to bring all virtuous phenomena to perfect completion. Heedfulness is the complete dedication to awakening through the perfectly pure observance of moral discipline, combined with the non-desire for any rebirth whatsoever.

In that context, diligence is the patient endurance and contentment that comes from not attending to body and mind. Heedfulness is the protection of all sentient beings at all times with a mind free from anger.

In that context, diligence is the freedom from weariness in the genuine accomplishment of virtuous phenomena. Heedfulness is the complete dedication of all virtuous phenomena thus accomplished to omniscience itself.

In that context, diligence is the freedom from dedicating what has been genuinely accomplished through the limbs of meditative concentration. Heedfulness is the awareness that turns back from seeking the taste of meditative concentration.

In that context, diligence is the insatiable seeking of extensive learning. Heedfulness is the noble wisdom and gnosis that rests in proper mental engagement.

In that context, diligence is the non-abandonment of the means of gathering. Heedfulness is the skillful means for bringing sentient beings to full maturation.

In that context, diligence is the firm taking hold of body and mind. Heedfulness is the seclusion of body and mind.

In that context, diligence is the evenness of mind toward all sentient beings through loving-kindness that takes sentient beings as its object. Heedfulness is the non-apprehension of all phenomena through loving-kindness that takes

phenomena as its object.

In that context, diligence is the engagement of other sentient beings and other persons in the awakening mind. Heedfulness is the non-forgetting of the awakening mind through discerning investigation into phenomena as though they were illusions.

In that context, diligence is the cultivation of the gnosis of superknowledge. Heedfulness is the protection at all times through bringing the defilements to exhaustion.

In that context, diligence is the seeking of truth as if one's head and clothing were on fire. Heedfulness is the non-falling into the direct realization of cessation.

In that context, diligence is the insatiable accumulation of virtuous roots for the purpose of perfectly completing the major and minor marks. Heedfulness is the discerning investigation into the dharmakāya.

In that context, diligence is the complete purification of buddha fields. Heedfulness is the complete purification of the fields of sentient beings.

In that context, diligence is the perfect completion of the thirty-seven factors conducive to awakening. Heedfulness is the liberation through the liberation of pacification and stilling.

Son of good family, in brief, all the deeds of a bodhisattva skilled in means are to be regarded as endowed with diligence. All the deeds of the Perfection of Wisdom are to be regarded as endowed with heedfulness. Therefore it should be understood that for a bodhisattva who is fully sustained by skillful means and wisdom, there is not even the slightest fear of turning back from unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening.

When this teaching had been spoken, the wanderer Jīnabuddhi attained acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena. In that very joy, delight, and elation, he rose up into the sky above to a height of about seven tāla trees. This great trichiliocosm of world systems trembled in six ways. A great radiance pervaded the world. From the sky above, a great rain of flowers fell down. And sounds of music and song arose.

Then at that moment the Blessed One smiled. When the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, smile,

rays of light in many and various colors issued forth from the mouth of the Blessed One — blue, yellow, red, white, tawny, crystal-colored, and silver-colored. These pervaded the boundless and limitless world systems with their radiance, appearing everywhere down to the world of Brahmā, outshining even the light of the sun and moon, and then returning again. Three times they circled the Blessed One, and then they sank into the crown of the Blessed One's head.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his outer robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and with palms pressed together bowed in the direction of the Blessed One. In a melodious verse, he asked the meaning of the smile:

You are adorned with a fathom's aura of incomparable glory,
the power of merit and gnosis, unrivaled in splendor.
Adorned with the thirty-two supreme major marks
and beautified with the minor marks,
you walk with the majestic, unhurried stride of a supreme lion,
arisen by the power of diligence.
Why do you smile? May the Blessed One reveal this.

O Sage, your voice surpasses the summer cloud and the thunderclap,
surpasses even the lion's roar,
surpasses the call of the kalavinka bird, the sound of a bell,
and the voice of Brahmā.

Whatever pleasing sounds of gods or humans
resound through the three thousandfold world —
none of them can approach the supreme speech
of the Blessed One, the Sage.

Not even the supreme arhats, the solitary buddhas,
or the bodhisattvas can fathom
the wondrous, incomparable gnosis
of the matchless sovereign Sage.

Whatever gods, humans, asuras, or nāgas hear it
seek out supreme awakening.
By the power of that gnosis,
please explain why you have smiled.

Your mind is freed from every extreme view,
O Benevolent One, you do not cling to any center.

Without attachment, without fault,
your conduct is like the boundless sky, dwelling nowhere.
There is no supreme example, no worldly peer
by which you may be reckoned.
You whose mind is like space, you who are without sin —
I ask: why have you smiled?

From your mouth have issued rays of light, various hues —
blue and red and white,
blazing like immaculate gold and red,
as numerous as the sands of the Gaṅgā.
They have illuminated world systems in every direction,
equal in number to the countless realms of space.
Every lower realm touched by the Sage's light
is pacified entirely and suffused with bliss.
If the rays sink down to your knees, you are prophesying an arhat.
If the rays sink to your shoulders, you are prophesying a solitary buddha.
But now, O Sage who brings benefit,
immaculate light has sunk into your crown —
this surely prophesies that you
will be confirmed in the vehicle of omniscience and equality.
Therefore, O One who is better than the best,
worshipped by gods and more than gods,
worthy of worship by all three worlds,
the many living beings who have heard this
rejoice and their minds are delighted.
Speak out in true and certain words —
let the Victor tell us:
why have you smiled? Dispel this doubt,
and gladden your disciples.

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to the venerable Ānanda:
"Ānanda, do you see this noble son named Victorious Intellect, who has
attained acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena, and who sits up in the
sky about seven tāla trees high, with palms pressed together paying homage
to me, while hundreds of thousands of gods make offerings to him?"

"Blessed One, I see him," he replied.

The Blessed One then declared: "Ānanda, when this noble son Victorious Intellect had become a wheel-turning king, he planted roots of virtue in connection with seventy-two million buddhas, and made offerings to all those blessed buddhas, the Blessed Ones — both while they resided and after they had passed fully beyond sorrow. In the presence of those seventy-two million buddhas he practiced the holy life.

In every case he completely upheld the sacred Dharma. Ānanda, from this day forward this noble son Victorious Intellect will go on pleasing, revering, honoring, paying homage to, making offerings to, and practicing the holy life before incalculable Tathāgatas beyond counting. He will also bring immeasurable and innumerable sentient beings to complete maturation in awakening. Then, in a future time, having fully accomplished the qualities conducive to awakening, after incalculable eons, in a precious eon called Adorned with a Single Jewel, in a world system called Pleasing to Behold, he will arise in this world as a Tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly and completely awakened buddha by the name of Heap of Wisdom — accomplished in knowledge and conduct, a Sugata, knower of the world, an unsurpassed guide of persons to be tamed, Teacher of gods and humans, a buddha, a Blessed One.

Ānanda, the enjoyments of that world system called Pleasing to Behold will be comparable to those of the gods of the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Emanations. Not a single disagreeable phenomenon arising from the six sense objects will appear before those sentient beings. Whenever any of those sentient beings sees another, joy and happiness will arise. All those sentient beings, even in dreams, will behold the Tathāgata Heap of Wisdom, and they will never be parted from the recollection of the Buddha. That is why the world system is called Pleasing to Behold.

In that eon only that one Tathāgata will arise, and the lifespan of that Tathāgata will endure for a full eon. That is why that eon will be called Adorned with a Single Jewel.

The Saṅgha of that Blessed One will consist solely of bodhisattvas — ninety-two hundred million bodhisattvas. Every one of those great bodhisattvas will be irreversible, of unobstructed eloquence, and accomplished in the analysis of language. When the Tathāgata Heap of Wisdom passes fully beyond sorrow, the bodhisattva Proceeding with Lion's Vigor will be present, and he will give the prophecy: "Noble son, this bodhisattva Proceeding with

Lion's Vigor will, after me, become the Tathāgata Proclaiming the Lion's Roar."
And having given that prophecy, he will pass fully beyond sorrow.

After the Tathāgata Heap of Wisdom passes fully beyond sorrow, the sacred Dharma will remain for ten intermediate eons. The body of that Blessed One will be imperishable, and for those sentient beings who make offerings to it there will be a single stupa made of precious substances, sixty-four yojanas in breadth and eighty yojanas in height, adorned with every kind of precious material.

Then the noble son Victorious Intellect descended from the sky and, bowing his head to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated the Blessed One three times. He then praised the Blessed One with these verses inseparable from the dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena:

The expanse of self and the expanse of sentient beings,
the dharmadhātu — these are equal to one another.
The expanse of wisdom that partakes of that expanse —
it is for this reason that you have given me the prophecy.

The dharmadhātu and the element of affliction,
the expanse of emptiness — these are equal to one another.
All phenomena partake of that expanse —
it is for this reason that you have given me the prophecy.

Attachment, aversion, and delusion —
and those other three elements as well —
these are equal to the element of space.
It is for this reason that you have given me the prophecy.

Saṃsāra and nirvāṇa:
the dharmadhātu is equal to them both.
The elements of wind, water, and fire,
and earth — these all partake of that element.
They are equal to the element of the aggregates.
The elements beginning with the eye,
the element of mind, and the element of phenomena —
all their expanse is one and equal.

Whatever the expanse of the conditioned,
whatever the expanse of the unconditioned —
these two are non-dual in the dharmadhātu.

It is for this reason that you have given me the prophecy.

The aggregates are devoid of consciousness;
so too are the elements and the sense sources.

They are not found in name, nor found in form,
not found within, nor found without.

The Sage gave me the prophecy
by means of those sounds through which understanding arises.
Just as the sound was spoken,
so in that way the prophecy was given to me.

The mind by virtue of which the prophecy was given to me
is not possessed of buddhahood,
and likewise in me there is no consciousness
that has been prophesied to attain perfect awakening.

Just as a buddha is, so am I;
just as I am, so is the Sugata.

All sentient beings are likewise the same.

It is for this reason that you have given me the prophecy.

This prophecy is true,
endowed with suchness.

Because it abides at the ultimate limit,
there is no distinction within the dharmadhātu.

It arose from the dharmadhātu itself,
and its wisdom is as deep as space.

To you, the Blessed One, skilled in means and thoroughly trained —
to you I bow.

Having praised the Blessed One with those verses inseparable from the dharmadhātu, the bodhisattva Victorious Intellect bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side.

Then the venerable Śāriputra and Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful spoke to one another about what had been directly witnessed by Śāriputra himself — just a portion — of the miraculous displays of Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful's supernatural powers and of the miraculous displays of his teaching of the Dharma through transformation. In the same way, they recounted to one another, in the presence of the Blessed One, the miraculous displays of

Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful's playful supernatural powers and the miraculous displays of his teaching of the Dharma through transformation, just as these had appeared directly before them.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, take up this enumeration of the Dharma, learn it, uphold it, master it thoroughly, and expound it widely and completely to others."

Ānanda replied: "Blessed One, if I am to take up this enumeration of the Dharma, what is the name of this enumeration of the Dharma, and how am I to take it up?"

The Blessed One declared: "Therefore, Ānanda, take up this enumeration of the Dharma under these names: 'The Miraculous Display of the Blessings of Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful'; 'That Which Defeats and Utterly Destroys All Demonic and Adversarial Opposition in Accordance with the Dharma'; 'The Revelation of the Source of the Three Jewels'; and 'The Casket of the Three Jewels.'"

After the Blessed One had so declared, Mañjuśrī the Ever-Youthful, the bodhisattva Victorious Intellect, the venerable Ānanda, those bodhisattvas, those great śrāvakas, the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas — the entire world — rejoiced and acclaimed what the Blessed One had taught.

This completes the Great Vehicle sūtra entitled The Casket of the Three Jewels.

Translated by the great editor-monk Ratnarakṣita, and revised and finalized in the new orthographic style.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase "entered into what is without fault" renders "skyon med pa la zhugs pa," referring to those who have entered the faultless state of personal liberation, that is, the nirvāṇa of the lesser vehicle. The doctrinal point Mañjuśrī is making is a characteristically Mahāyāna one: those who have prematurely settled into individual liberation, even though it is "faultless," are not suitable vessels for the buddha qualities; only those who remain engaged with saṃsāra out of compassion, free from both attachment and aversion to existence, are genuine vessels.

The "three defilements" most likely refers to the three root afflictions — attachment, aversion, and delusion — though in some contexts this phrase can refer to the defilements of the three realms.

- The phrase rendered "the three knowledges" translates rig pa gsum, which in Buddhist usage typically refers to the three higher knowledges or vidyās: recollection of past lives, knowledge of the death and rebirth of beings, and knowledge of the exhaustion of defilements. This is the standard reading in Mahāyāna scholastic contexts.

The distinction between grain oil and butter as vessels for śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, while honey and molasses serve as the analogy for bodhisattvas, is slightly unexpected from a hierarchical standpoint. The Tibetan is clear; the text may be making a point about the sweetness and richness appropriate to the bodhisattva path rather than ranking the vessels by status.

- The term rendered "solitariness" is the Tibetan "dben pa nyid," which can mean aloneness, isolation, or solitude, and here functions as a near-synonym for emptiness, indicating the absence of inherent relational or conceptual elaboration. The pairing of emptiness and solitariness as "beginning" and "end" is an unusual formulation worth noting for doctrinal study, though the translation follows the text literally.

The comparison of gold and a hollow reed (sa le sbram) is a somewhat obscure analogy. The point appears to be that two things sharing the same essential nature (here, emptiness) differ only nominally, just as "gold" and "a hollow reed" or "a straw" might refer to different things by name yet share a common empty nature. The exact term "sa le sbram" is slightly uncertain in its reference but likely denotes a particular plant stalk or reed.

- The phrase rendered "those who dwell in duality" translates a term meaning those who engage with or move within a dualistic framework; this is a standard Madhyamaka and Yogācāra soteriological point about the inability of dualistic minds to grasp non-dual reality.

The final line, "those who take delight in the ground of all," refers to practitioners attached to the all-base consciousness, the ālayavijñāna, as a substantial ground or refuge — a critique found in certain Madhyamaka and Yogācāra polemics against reifying the store consciousness.

- The phrase rendered "the perception of dedication" translates "bsngo ba'i 'du shes," meaning the conceptual perception that there is something to dedicate or transfer — a subtle form of reification that obstructs the highest realization. This is consistent with the Prajñāpāramitā literature's insistence that even meritorious mental acts, when conceptually grasped, are hindrances.

The "view of the transitory collection" (Skt. satkāyadrṣṭi) is the innate or acquired view that there is a real, enduring self within the psycho-physical aggregates. Its presence is here identified as the root of fear before the teaching of non-self and emptiness.

- The phrase rendered "falls, dissolving into the essence of awakening" translates the Tibetan literally as "falls toward the essence of awakening into cessation." The syntax is compressed and slightly ambiguous: it could mean the bodhisattva's residual samsaric existence is "struck down" and he passes into nirvāṇa at the seat of awakening, or that he "falls into" final awakening. The translation follows the most natural doctrinal reading given the sāla tree simile, in which falling to the ground represents the bodhisattva's ultimate attainment of buddhahood after being sustained by compassion. This is a genuinely consequential ambiguity worth flagging.

- The horse name rendered phonetically as Cāṅgśes is a Tibetan term meaning "fully knowing" or "supremely intelligent." This is likely a proper name or epithet for a celebrated type of horse rather than a personal name in the strict sense; the precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain.

The yak king "Sasruṅ" is a Tibetan name whose exact Sanskrit correlate is unclear. It may refer to a well-known figure in a Jātaka-style story preserved in this sūtra tradition.

The passage ends mid-sentence, which reflects the continuity instruction; the translation breaks off precisely where the Tibetan text provided ends.

- The kalavinka is a bird of beautiful song renowned in Indian Buddhist literature, often identified with the Indian cuckoo. Its voice is considered the most melodious of all birds. The image of the chick singing within the egg is a classical simile for the bodhisattva who, still

within conditioned existence and not yet liberated, already proclaims the deepest Dharma teachings.

The Pārijāta is a divine wish-fulfilling tree said to grow in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three (Trāyastriṃśa), celebrated for its flowers. The passage ends mid-simile and the corresponding doctrinal application presumably follows in the next section.

- The "four means of gathering disciples" renders རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, the four means of attraction or social bonds by which a bodhisattva gathers beings: generosity, kind speech, beneficial conduct, and consistency of purpose.

The "four blessings" renders རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་. The precise enumeration of these four varies across texts and is not specified here; the translation preserves the deliberate structural parallel with the four great elements.

The image of the vajra piercing jewels while remaining unpierced is a standard Indian metaphor for invincible spiritual power; "vajra gem" renders རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, which oscillates between the sense of a vajra-hard jewel and a jewel-like vajra — the precise referent is intentionally ambiguous in context.

- The passage renders "རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" as a list of roots from which bodhisattvas are pure. The phrase "རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" is somewhat paradoxical — being pure from the root of the view of the transitory collection is a standard Abhidharma category for the satkāyadṛṣṭi, the view that takes the aggregates as a self. The sense is that bodhisattvas are free even from this as a reified root, which fits the surrounding apophatic discourse.

The closing series of negations echoes the Vimalakīrtinirdeśa and related Prajñāpāramitā literature; no single negation is meant as a simple assertion of the opposite, but as a dismantling of all conceptual anchoring.

- The phrase rendered "individual perfect knowledge" translates རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, a technical term (Skt. pratisaṃvid or pratyātmāyajñāna depending on context) meaning the direct, personal, discriminative knowledge attained by an arhat. The exchange exploits the tension between this attainment and the unbounded knowing proper to buddhas and bodhisattvas. The section break "The Second Fascicle" renders རྒྱུ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, a standard Tibetan division marker for the second textual bundle of the manuscript.

- The phrase rendered "entered into the equanimity of the night" translates "nam nang du yang dag 'jog par gyur pa," which more literally means "having settled into the proper stillness of midnight" — a formulaic expression for the Buddha entering a meditative rest or absorption at night. The rendering given captures the sense without disrupting the flow.

The term "scatter-wind" for "rnam par 'thor rlung" describes a violent dispersing wind, used here as a simile for the overwhelming force that causes the hearer to collapse. The image is a bird caught in such a wind and dashed to the ground.

- The phrase rendered "non-returner, a being of one more birth" translates phyir mi ldog pa skye ba gcig gis thogs pa, which in standard Mahāyāna usage designates a bodhisattva who is irreversible and separated from full buddhahood by only one more birth, not the śrāvaka-path "non-returner" (anāgāmin). The two epithets are distinct here and the rendering reflects that.

The sequence of verbs rendered "make inquiry and make thorough inquiry" translates yongs su zhu ba and yongs su legs par zhu ba, a standard honorific dyad for presenting a question and presenting it well or completely; no single elegant English equivalent exists, so both are preserved.

- The exchange between Mañjuśrī and Prajñādīpa turns on a subtle dialectic about the relationship between conventional and ultimate truth, and whether "truth" (bden pa) is singular

at the ultimate level. The argument that if the conventional did not "gather into" or converge on the ultimate then there would be no ultimate is a compressed Madhyamaka-style move; the rendering tries to preserve that logical compression without over-interpreting.

The final line ends mid-sentence — "He replied:" — because the Tibetan passage itself breaks off there with ལྟེན་པར་གྱི་ལྟེན་པར་ and the response is not given in this excerpt.

- The "three defining marks" refers to the three marks of conditioned existence in Abhidharma analysis: arising, abiding, and ceasing. Mañjuśrī's dilemma presents a classic tetralemma-style argument: wisdom cannot be conditioned (or it would be impermanent) and cannot be unconditioned (since the unconditioned admits no designation), pointing toward a non-conceptual, non-dual understanding.

The buddha Raśmīketu renders Tibetan ར་སྐྱིལ་ཀེ་ཏུ་, meaning "pinnacle of light," here kept as the Sanskrit reconstruction Raśmīketu for consistency with standard identification of this buddha in this sūtra.

The phrase "gateways of solitude" renders 空寂門, where 空寂 means solitude, seclusion, or emptiness of inherent existence in context. The doctrinal point is that all Dharma teachings point ultimately to the empty, unelaborate nature of reality.

• The compound "हृदयसर्पवृक्षकाचलन्दिनिर्द्वारोपगच्छन्ति" is rendered as "heartwood of sandalwood serpent-wood," following the reading of candanasāra as a compound name for a fragrant wood; some witnesses read it as two items, sandalwood and serpent-wood, but the construction here supports a single compound. "kacalindi" is a textile fiber of uncertain botanical identification mentioned in Sanskrit sources; it is left untranslated as a proper name. The phrase "निरद्वारोपगच्छन्ति" is rendered "who have not opened that door," meaning those who have not yet entered that level of realization.

- The bird called "gulika" (Tibetan: bya lang gu li) is not entirely certain in identification. It appears to be a common domestic fowl or chicken, serving as a contrast to the mighty Garuḍa. The rendering "common fowl" is contextually appropriate.

The name "Kunadin" is a tentative phonetic rendering of the Tibetan kun byin. The name could also be read as "Sarvadatta" in Sanskrit reconstruction. The name "Dharmecchu" reconstructs the Sanskrit implied by chos 'dod, meaning "one who desires the Dharma."

The phrase rendered as "because the continuity of their habitual tendencies has not been severed, may remain unequal, yet I knew myself to be equal" is a compressed and somewhat difficult passage. The sense appears to be that Śāriputra, as a śrāvaka, recognizes that śrāvakas are objectively unequal to a bodhisattva like Mañjuśrī because they have not cut the continuity of habitual tendencies, yet he personally knew himself to be on a par — a cognition that is then shown to be mistaken by Mañjuśrī's demonstration.

- The phrase rendered "a wisdom that is of one orientation" translates "phyogs gcig pa'i ye shes," meaning a gnosis or wisdom that is partial or directed in only one direction, as opposed to the omnidirectional or fully panoramic wisdom of a buddha. The point is that Śāriputra, while extraordinarily accomplished, has a wisdom that is oriented in only one direction, whereas the speaker's is not so limited, yet even so the speaker placed Śāriputra as his equal out of compassion or skillful means.

The closing statement by Mañjuśrī that all buddha-fields are seen as "the field of space" is a classic Mahāyāna teaching on the non-fabricated, non-conditional nature of the ultimate: space is the only example given of something not produced by conditions and abiding by its own intrinsic nature, making it an analogue for emptiness or the dharmadhātu. The ordinary cognitions that see fire, water, flourishing, and destruction are true at the conventional level but are adventitious and therefore not ultimate.

- The final sentence is left open as the Tibetan passage ends mid-scene with Mañjuśrī in his dwelling with Śakra and others not yet named, accurately reflecting the text's cut-off point.

- The phrase "like a lion sending forth his roar" is embedded in Māra's internal thought and characterises Mañjuśrī's confident entry into the city; the lion's roar is a standard idiom for fearless proclamation of the Dharma.

- The phrase rendered "the patience that realizes the birthlessness and non-arising of all phenomena" translates the technical term for the anutpattikadharmakṣānti, the bodhisattva's patient acceptance of the non-arising nature of phenomena, a standard Mahāyāna attainment marker.

- The term rendered "home, refuge, island, and ally" renders gnas, skyabs, gling, and dpung gnyen respectively — a classical fourfold formula for the shelter provided by the Dharma; "island" here renders gling in its standard Pali/Sanskrit parallel as dīpa/dvīpa, meaning a place of refuge or firm ground, not a geographical island per se.

- The phrase rendered "relinquished their vital formations" translates tshe'i 'du byed spangs

pa, literally "abandoned the formations of life," a technical idiom for voluntarily ending one's life through yogic means — an act presented here without censure, in the context of preventing the spectacle of the Dharma's decline. This is doctrinally significant and commentators discuss it in terms of the attainment and resolve of advanced practitioners.

The epithet "Ānanda" is used throughout for kun dga' bo, his Sanskrit name meaning "Blissful One," consistently rendered by name here as the context is clearly the Buddha's attendant Ānanda.

- The buddha-field name translated as "Precious Life-Tree" renders the Tibetan Rin chen srog shing, a compound meaning something like "precious tree of life" or "precious vital tree." This appears to be a proper name of a buddha-field and its Sanskrit equivalent is not recoverable from the Tibetan alone with certainty.

The phrase rendered "without remainder" in the first sentence reflects the Tibetan len pa med par, literally "without remainder" or "without grasping," a technical formula indicating the arhat's liberation without residue.

- The passage shifts into first-person narration by Mahākāśyapa, who is recounting events to the Blessed One and then being addressed in return. The Tibetan uses the humble first-person pronoun throughout, which the translation renders as "I" and "me" consistently for Kāśyapa's voice. The phrase rendered "one-sided understanding" translates shes pa phyogs gcig pa dang ldan pa, literally "possessed of a cognition that has one direction or side," meaning a limited, partial, or one-track understanding — a conventional expression of Kāśyapa's self-deprecation before the boundless range of bodhisattva activity.

- The passage lists a series of means by which sentient beings are brought to ripening. The term rendered "being seized and disciplined" (བཏུག་བཀུར་བྱེད་པ་) could also be read as "grasping firmly" in the sense of a tight embrace or physical restraint; the doctrinal context suggests forceful or wrathful means of taming, so "seized and disciplined" is retained. The term rendered "impoverishment and destitution" (འཕྲོད་པ་ལྷོད་པ་) may refer to deliberately inducing a state of poverty as a skillful means of ripening. The bilious fever simile (འཕྲོད་པ་ལྷོད་པ་) is a classical Āyurvedic reference; ghee enema or oleation treatment is standard for bilious conditions. The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan; the translation reflects this natural break.

- The term translated as "equal to an echo" renders brag ca dang mnyam pa nyid, literally "equality with an echo" — a standard simile for the quality of buddha-speech: like an echo, it arises in response to conditions without inherent origination. This is a doctrinally significant image worth flagging.

The phrase rendered "those sentient beings who by nature have passed beyond sorrow" is somewhat elliptical in the Tibetan and may alternatively mean "for the sake of sentient beings, with a mind naturally oriented toward nirvāṇa." The translation given follows the more literal reading.

- The phrase rendered "equal to the five fingers of space" is somewhat unusual. The Tibetan reads "the characteristic of being equal to the fingers of space," which may indicate that great compassion extends as widely as space in every direction, the five fingers being a figure for the expanse of space in all directions. This is an idiomatic image whose precise doctrinal referent is not entirely transparent from the Tibetan alone.

The passage describing the bodhisattva who "deliberately takes up existence" through the characteristic of "clearing away existence" encapsulates a classical Mahāyāna paradox: the bodhisattva has the capacity to exit saṃsāra entirely but intentionally takes rebirth for the benefit of beings. This is rendered literally in keeping with the doctrinal point.

- The Venerable Gāṃgāputra who speaks here is identified by his name (གུང་གླ་པ་ལྷོ་པ་),

which means "Gāṅgāputra" or "Son of the Gaṅgā," a named elder distinct from the standard list of Śākyamuni's great disciples; this name is preserved as given.

The phrase རྒྱལ་མཆོག་གི་མཆོག་པོ་ (Truthful Son of the Naked Ones) is a personal name or title of a naked Jain or Ājīvika ascetic teacher; the text treats it throughout as a proper designation, and it is rendered accordingly.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the supplied Tibetan; the translation breaks off at exactly that point.

- The passage presents an elaborately structured set of triadic teachings on "good in the beginning, good in the middle, and good in the end" — a classical formula applied first to the śrāvaka path and then to the bodhisattva path. The text enumerates multiple such triads in sequence; the translation preserves all of them in order. The birth-narrative of Gautama with the seven steps, the two water-streams, and the proclamation follows standard canonical accounts but here is voiced by Mañjuśrī in the guise of a non-Buddhist praising the Buddha to a non-Buddhist audience, which is the narrative frame established in the preceding passage.
- The phrase rendered "a mind equal to the earth" translates རྒྱལ་མཆོག་གི་མཆོག་པོ་, literally "a mind like the earth," which is a standard Mahāyāna metaphor for the bodhisattva's boundless, imperturbable patience and capacity to bear all beings, here functioning as a description of foundational bodhicitta that must not be relinquished.

The line "bound by just one more birth" renders རྒྱལ་མཆོག་གི་མཆོག་པོ་, a technical term for the penultimate bodhisattva stage before buddhahood, equivalent to the Sanskrit ekajātīpratibaddha.

The five emanations' declaration follows the classical Perfection of Wisdom rhetorical pattern in which each of the Three Jewels and the Four Noble Truths is affirmed in its ultimate nature precisely by negating any grasping approach to them; the somewhat paradoxical formulations are intentional doctrinal statements, not textual errors.

- The passage concludes a long series of paradoxical renunciations in which the bodhisattvas declare that, because the ultimate nature of each practice-object is beyond elaboration, they do not "seek" or strive for it in any conventional sense. The rhetorical structure is consistent throughout the preceding passage.

The phrase rendered "we are not those of few desires" and "we are not those who know contentment" — where the negative particle negates the classical ascetic virtues of few desires and contentment — is deliberately paradoxical: the bodhisattvas are not claiming to lack these virtues but are asserting that, at the ultimate level, even these virtues cannot be grasped as objects of pursuit. The same logic applies to seclusion, absence of affliction, and the rest of the negated qualities in the second half of the passage.

The rendering of "dge sbyong" as śramaṇa and "bram ze" as brahmin follows the standard Indo-Tibetan usage where these terms denote Buddhist and brahminical ideals of spiritual attainment respectively, here reinterpreted in light of ultimate reality rather than conventional religious status.

- The passage opens with the four qualities of liberation — permanence, bliss, self, and purity — which directly echo the four "inverted" or "distorted" attributes (viparyāsa) traditionally attributed to saṃsāra (impermanence mistaken for permanence, etc.), here applied positively to liberation itself. This is consistent with the tathāgatagarbha doctrinal register of the text, where liberation is paradoxically described with the very attributes ordinarily denied to conditioned existence.

The phrase rendered "in the final existence" for རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་གྱི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་ refers to monks who have attained the highest mundane meditative absorptions and will take one final rebirth before liberation — a recognized technical category — but who have falsely claimed the supramundane attainment of arhatship. This distinction is significant to the narrative's critique of spiritual pride.

- The monk addressed as "Gampopa" in this passage is almost certainly a conventional rendering of a term of address — the Tibetan "གཤམ་པོ་པ་" (Gaṅgopa or similar) appears to be a vocative used by the Blessed One to address Mañjuśrī's interlocutor or narrator. It is not the famous eleventh-century Tibetan master Gampopa (sGam po pa). The name functions as a proper address within the sūtra frame, and its exact identity in the Sanskrit source is uncertain; it may correspond to a name like "Gaṅgottara" or similar. This should be kept in mind if the full text is identified.

The phrase "Brahmin, what is the word called 'true' ..." follows directly from the preceding dialogue, with the Blessed One addressing an unnamed brahmin interlocutor in that quotation.

- The Tibetan passage presents the twelve links of dependent origination in both their arising and cessation modes, closely following canonical sūtra formulation. The phrase rendered "formations constructed through inversion" translates "log par bsgrub pa'i 'du byed kyi lam," literally "the path of formations accomplished through inversion" — meaning the arising chain driven by distorted mental engagement, as opposed to the cessation chain driven by correct mental engagement.

The name "Satyadeva" renders "bden pa po," literally "truth-one" or "possessor of truth," which here appears to be a proper name. "Son of the Nirgrantha woman" renders "gcer bu ma'i bu," identifying him as the son of a Nirgrantha (Jain) woman.

- The phrase rendered "wrong kind of grasping" translates log pa'i gzung bas bzungs, literally "taken hold of by a wrong taking-hold." The doctrinal nuance is that Gautama has captivated them through erroneous attachment to his teaching from the tīrthika perspective — the accusation is that his "enticement" constitutes a spiritually corrupting seizure of their minds. The irony, developed in Victorious Intellect's speech, is that the opposite is true.

The "six teachers" refers to the famous six heterodox teachers of the Buddha's time, the standard list of rival śramaṇa teachers in early Buddhist literature, including figures such as Pūraṇa Kāśyapa and Makkhali Gosāla.

- The phrase rendered "manifest pride" translates mngon pa'i nga rgyal, a technical term denoting the specific transgression of a monastic who falsely claims — or pridefully misrepresents — supramundane attainments to laypersons. It is distinguished in Vinaya literature from ordinary arrogance and is sometimes rendered "vaunting pride" or "presumptuous pride." The rendering "manifest pride" preserves both the technical Vinaya sense and the literal force of the compound.

The puzzling passage stating that ordinary beings will pass beyond sorrow while arhats will not, and that ordinary beings will see the Tathāgata while arhats will not, reflects a Mahāyāna polemical context: from the Great Vehicle perspective, arhats who have entered nirvāṇa are temporarily "absorbed" and thus miss the opportunity to hear the Dharma and encounter future buddhas, whereas ordinary beings who remain in saṃsāra retain that possibility. The series of such statements is a test of attachment to the śrāvaka path.

- The name རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་གྱི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་, literally "wanderer Jinabuddhi" (Skt. Jinabuddhi), combines the title རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་གྱི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་ (parivrājaka, wandering ascetic) with the proper name རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་གྱི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་. Similarly, རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་གྱི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་ and རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་གྱི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་ are wanderers named Upācāra and Candrasambandha respectively. The phrase རྒྱུ་གྲོལ་གྱི་འཕྲིན་ལྷན་, rendered "wealth and possessions acquired through

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.